



DISCOVERING

Magazine

KT MORRISON

DISCOVERING MAGGIE

KT MORRISON

This is a work of fiction. Similarities to real people, places, or events are entirely coincidental.

Models on cover are meant for illustrative purposes only.

DISCOVERING MAGGIE

A MAGGIE novella.

First Edition. July 24, 2017.

Copyright © 2017 KT Morrison

Written by KT Morrison

Cover by KT Morrison

Contents

1. [Ballgown](#)
2. [Prowler](#)
3. [Trothplight](#)
4. [Regency](#)
5. [Couch](#)
6. [Terry](#)
7. [Statue](#)
8. [Game Show](#)
9. [Burgeon](#)
10. [Midnight](#)
11. [Three](#)
12. [Breakup](#)

[Afterword](#)

[Other Books by KT Morrison](#)

Ballgown

SATURDAY, OCTOBER 7TH

THEY PARKED Carol's Porsche out front of the Seamen's Church Institute, which prompted a secret smirk that had to be hidden.

The bridal shoppe her mother had selected was located in a renovated 18th century commercial wharf that overlooked Newport Harbor and Goat Island beyond. Couldn't see the island today; gray and dim, foggy, a low, cottony brume that sat over the strangely still water of the harbor. They had stepped quickly from the car, along the red brick walk that paved between the buildings of this old wharf revitalized into a stylish and upscale shopping venue and yachting club. Rain seemed imminent, but now, standing in the private, appointment-only boutique, it still hadn't arrived.

They were on the second floor of the boutique, the view from the window stabbed repeatedly from the bobbing masts of tied off sailboats immediately below in the harbor. Carol was busy with private and hushed talk with the boutique owner, who sat with Carol on the board for the Rhode Island Preservation Society and the Robert Williams Park Zoo. The two WASPiest boards her Chinese mother could ever sit on, but they welcomed her with wide open arms because Carol Becker got shit done and she sent weaklings running.

Maggie was engaged with two effusively helpful assistants; bringing her dresses, zipping her up, helping her with shoes, bringing her green tea, fawning and preening. Her hair had been tied up at a salon down the street before they arrived, roughly imitating how it would be done on her wedding day (her mother assuring the stylists that Maggie would have her natural hair color then). The boutique assistants, two girls in their mid-twenties,

professionally and sedately dressed, would take strands of her hair and pull them down her shoulders, their knuckles grazing her skin and giving her chills. The whole while only watching her in the reflection of the tall and wide mirror, divided in three and angled in a bay, the edges in elaborate gilded gold frame. To her right stood a sturdy garment rack on heavy rubber wheels. More than a dozen dresses hung on the rack. Mother had arranged for her to try on numerous styles, ranging from Trumpets to A-Lines. All in white—and while she considered herself a bride who should wear white, it felt conspicuous today, even if it were only to her. The events of the last few days, while exciting, were brought into dirty focus by today's appointment.

Now, yesterday's appointment was enraging, and she was still mad at her mother over it. But of course, as usual, she would never say a word, never utter disapproval, though it would drip from every word she said to her mother over the next few days. Carol would know why, but nothing would change.

The entire day was spent sitting on her ass and playing her cello at a Law Society function her mother hosted. It was dreadfully important and Maggie didn't put up any fuss, wouldn't have even if it had been unimportant. Two one-hour performances, then trotted around and shown off to all the executives Carol needed to impress. There were more than a few young and handsome esquires present but she didn't once entertain any ideas of flirting or even fantasies of one of them slipping a hand up her skirt while she jerked him off underneath his jacket. One: she really did love Max, and the excitement of having him watch her with Jay had worn away, and even the idea of the train-hunk had less appeal twenty-four hours later. In fact, today, if her love could be weighed, she had even heavier affection for young Max Milton. Reason Two: those young lawyer boys knew Carol Becker's reputation, and were scared shitless of her which meant her (very sexy, thank you) daughter was off-limits. The whole day was lost yesterday, in preparation, travel, tuning, playing, eating, playing again, hobnobbing, more travel...

"My, my," the boutique owner sighed, a tall white woman called Pippy, with gray hair rinsed in blonde and held back in tortoiseshell clips. "Look how beautiful your daughter is."

"Isn't she?" Carol said, in a convincing imitation of a human being.

"She studies art?" the woman asked Carol, the two of them talking about her and not to her.

“Yes, she’s top of her class at Farmingham. In Vermont.”

Appreciative nodding and cooing followed, one of the assistants’ eyes met hers in the mirror and she smiled warmly. The girl softly said, “You have the most beautiful skin I’ve ever seen.” Her knuckles grazed along her collar and down her shoulder and Maggie’s nipples went to diamonds under her bustier, the hair flinching along the back of her neck.

“Thank you,” she said.

“It’s like cream. What do you think of this one? I think you are stunning in it.”

She held the skirt of the dress out and admired it. The assistants backed away and Maggie twirled left and right, throwing glances over her shoulder. This would be the dress in which she would marry Max.

“This is it, mother.” she said.

Carol smiled, nodded to Pippy.

The bare-shoulder ballgown in pure white made her pale skin seem tan. The bustier swooped in two embroidered clamshells that gave her meager bosom the appearance of volume. The waist came in so narrow, then the skirt bloomed out excitedly.

The assistant said, “Usually the ball gown is too much for someone so slender and graceful, but you...this one is exquisite on you.”

“Thank you,” she said, beginning to beam.

Behind her Carol talked about Max now.

“Her groom is summa, also at Farmingham. Investment banker. Very handsome.”

More cooing and small talk while the assistants made notes on adjustments, tabbed pins in certain places and she moved in circles with her arms held out letting them work.

When the tailoring was arranged, they reversed all the adjustments so she could disrobe. Next to the room they were in was a smaller space for her privacy. In there she stood, one last moment admiring how she would look on her wedding day, head cocking and tilting, looking in the tall mirror in its wooden stand. Light came from a single big window in this space; beyond, stormy Newport Harbor, water eerily still.

On an upholstered chair angled in the corner her purse sat, and she brought her phone out and regarded her reflection carefully. Smiling now she snapped a few pictures of herself. It brought a weird feeling, something audacious. She’d always been confident, proficient, knowing of her mental

abilities and talents, but recently something was brewing. Something like pride. Hopefully not vanity, but it wasn't far off, she supposed. In the mirror, she realized she looked better than good. Was it possible she was stunning? Now she laughed at her own ridiculous thoughts. Posed quickly, shot a hip out and gave herself a sassy smile, snapped a picture. It was a good one, her creamy skin, as the assistant had noted, looked brilliant and lively in the daylight coming through the maritime window. The edges of the gilded mirror were evident, the shining paint of the old wharf rafters above her, a bouquet of flowers on the table behind her.

It had to be shared but Max couldn't see. Drawing up her messenger she dashed it off to Cole. Her text read,

Maggie: What do you think?

Sat then in her wedding dress and waited to read what he would respond. There was nothing, and she fought a rise of ugly disappointment.

Outside she heard them talking. Mother tried to explain her daughter's artwork to Pippy. Pippy said it sounded wonderful. Then her mother said *It really was*.

Maggie made a funny face at herself in the mirror, her mother's rare compliment making her oddly uncertain, like the woman was up to something. Then Pippy asked her where she got the talent from.

"I suppose from me," Carol said.

"You're an artist?"

"I was at one time. In Hong Kong. I thought I was quite good. My father straightened me out." Mutual chuckling.

"Painting?"

Carol said, "Yes."

Maggie frowned at the door where the sounds traveled through. Her mother thought she was an artist?

Her phone binged.

Cole: Jesus Maggie

Maggie: bad or good?

Cole: breathtaking I mean it

Maggie: aw shucks

Cole: brought a tear to my eye

Maggie: I might just ruin ur rep after all

Cole: go ahead

Maggie: don't show Max-you know

Cole: I know the rules

Maggie: thank you

Cole: you are by far the most beautiful girl I've ever seen

Maggie: ok now you're going too far

Cole: wish I saw u first at that Lamda party

She laughed, frowned, crossed her legs under her gown.

Maggie: Then I wouldn't be sending u that picture

Cole: ha ha. no but I'd see it on the altar.

She closed off the app, stood, put her phone down on the cushion of the chair and walked to the window, looked up and down the wharf. It had begun to rain out there now, just a light but rapid falling that blurred the sky

and burred the surface of the harbor. Pedestrians below stretched out colorful umbrellas.

Back at her phone she opened that app again, texted Max.

Maggie: Ur not supposed to see me in my dress but maybe you want to see a preview of what ur getting

Max texted back instantly.

Max: you found ur dress?!

“Found my dress,” she sighed watching her reflection. The skirt was drawn up, bunching it at her waist; hitched a thumb into her panties and pulled them down to her knees, let them fall and stepped out of them. Her labia were bright pink, swollen and moist, and they glistened in this bright but rain-muffled light. Two fingers of her left hand ran through them, back and forth, brought them to life. When she had them posed, beautifully pressed between her long elegant fingers, diamond engagement ring winking back, white wedding dress skirt draping and framing her wet and hungry sex—she snapped a picture for her husband-to-be. She stood upright, skirt falling back to the floor, sent it to Max with bold confidence.

His response came immediately.

Max: Oh my God Maggie...I'm convinced ur trying to kill me.

Maggie: you dying for it?

Max: my heart is about to explode.

Maggie: see you tomorrow.

IN THE CAR Maggie asked her mother why she never told her she was an artist. Carol said *It's not something I tell people.*

Maggie asked no follow-up, sat quietly in the Cayenne's cognac leather seat, purring along the road from Newport to Jamestown and pondered *Why not?* Was it something Carol missed or something of which she was ashamed?

When they arrived home father was back from the business trip in Norway. He met her in the hallway on the second floor and took both her hands in his and kissed her cheek. They talked about the dress and he asked careful questions on the style and the tailoring but seemed distracted. The conversation petered, and he asked her to meet him in his study. Father went downstairs to the kitchen, presumably to greet his wife, and Maggie entered the austere, concrete cold of his home office. There were no sailboats on the bay today. The water was still, the sky foreboding.

A familiar dread settled on her, sitting in the leather chair across the desk from where her father reigned. There was something objectionable she had done, wasn't there? She knew it now, and her palms began to sweat and her heart fluttered lightly and timidly. This was all too familiar.

Before she could work herself into fearful panic father was there, coming in from the wide, doorless archway that separated his room from the main hallway. Wordlessly, he crossed behind her, came around the desk and sat himself on the other side.

He nodded his chin to her, raising it in a straight vertical line, a motion meant to instruct her to sit straighter. She did. Bottom lip pulled between teeth, she straightened her back and clasped her hands in her lap.

His hands came together on the blank, glass desk in front of him, big fingers weaving together. His hair was brushed back perfectly, thick, blonde, working its way to gray. He had powerful hands. Clothing today was typically austere and professional. Tailored suit in steel gray, a Sea Island cotton dress shirt open at the neck; tieless, but she knew he must have worn a tie earlier when he was traveling.

"Margaret," he began, like this was some troubling weight. "There are video cameras in this house arranged for security reasons."

Her insides frosted. Her outward demeanor was implacable—she was a Becker—but she had become an ice sculpture that someone draped creamy skin over, dressed it in fine casual clothing. She gave him nothing. Her face stayed blank and expectant. An innocent girl, patiently waiting for the rest

of the story. If Martin had seen a video of his daughter taking two men at once, in the conservatory he'd built for her as a child, she would be on the floor right now.

"On the last weekend, in the evening when your mother and I had gone to bed, can you explain what I saw?"

Jaw seizing and aching, she opened her mouth and creaked, "I don't understand..."

"Can you explain what is in the video?"

"No," she said, her stomach cramping. "What did you see?"

"Ah. That is the point," he said, his gaze lingering on her eyes.

If he had seen what happened, there would be no discussion, there would have been no dress-fitting today. She would have been punished. Quite surely she would have been forcefully admitted to a facility...some secluded Gothic mansion that treated the mentally ill offspring of the fabulously wealthy.

Her father said, "There wasn't a thing to see."

She held her poise, her mind racing at warp speed, trying to hurtle this conversation forward to its potential grand finale, desperate to know what he knew, desperate to know her level of punishment...

He continued, "Isn't that odd?"

"Why is it odd, sir?" she said, every muscle in her neck squeezing the shakiness from her voice, shaping artificial strength into it.

"Shouldn't there have been something to see? People in my house, moving around...the cameras, you see, are motion activated. So you can imagine my wonder at how my children, my daughter's fiancé, and their Best Man were able to get in and out of my house without moving at all."

Her face, struggling to remain composed and not give away any knowledge, sank now. Down into twisted, honest bewilderment. Why hadn't there been any video?

Martin prompted her, "Isn't that odd?"

"Yes, sir," she said. "It is."

"Why do you suppose there is no indication of any action transpiring in the halls and rooms while so many people were moving around?"

"I didn't know you had security cameras," she said as evenly and as calmly as she could. "Were they working during the evening? During dinner? When we had company? ..."

He sighed now, worked his head around in a contracted circle, hunched his shoulders up and leaned forward.

“How well do you know your friend Cole, Margaret?”

“Cole? Very well.”

He held her gaze coolly, drawing out this dreadful moment til it stretched thin as wire, said, “Someone has tampered with the security system.” Saying no more, he let it hang, shrinking her in his gaze, making her shake.

“You think Cole...”

“What do you think?”

“No. If I didn’t know there were cameras, how would he? And I don’t think he would know how to...and...and why?”

“Exactly, Margaret. Why?”

Her father’s face clouded. His usual dominant but calm demeanor stirring up like the stinging rain on the surface of the bay. Then it passed. That was the moment she feared. When she had earned her father’s genuine chagrin, and he was compelled to do something. To punish. It was delivered with cold, steely discipline, but it was always initialized with a tremor that passed through him. Like a trigger, something within him building up with his daughter’s displeasure, clouds coming across, skies threatening to break...then they did. And her father would punish her.

Behind him, over his left shoulder, stood a handmade bar. Cabinets below, shelving above, all straight lines and geometrical precision. At waist height there was a table top to prepare drinks. On the table were crystal glasses, a silver tray, a decanter and a wooden bucket. The table top was lined with a narrow, stainless railing. When she was punished, her father would make her grip that railing with both hands. Her skirt would be lifted and she would be spanked. Ten times. Never more, never less—despite the level of her punishable indiscretion, the number was the same. With her father, the punishment was discipline, the message not that striking her was parallel with the crime but that there was a threshold. Displeasing her parents was binary. You did, or you didn’t. It was meant to indicate to her the displeasure she brought.

Fucking Cole and Max would earn her a spanking. Ten times. *Only ten times?* Surely what she had done was worth more than that. It was an enormous indiscretion. One hundred? One thousand?

It would be welcomed. Let him. The deed, *the fucking*, was done. The deed would be done again. The threat of displeasing Carol and Martin was shrinking. What were ten strikes on her bottom in the grand scheme of things?

She could grip that rail, wait for her skirt to be lifted. She could take ten strikes. She could take a lot of punishment.

Her father would always undo his cufflinks, slowly dragging the moment as he was fond of doing. When you controlled the moment you could control the person. It was agonizing. Waiting for the sound of silver being set in front of her. Silver cuff links being set on his silver tray. Her skirt would drag on the back of her thighs...

Picturing it now, looking over her shoulder this time, only the man with his sleeves rolled up was Cole. He had her skirt lifted, his head turned down to look at the curve of her rump in her panties...

"Are you smiling to irritate me, Margaret?"

"What? No, sir, I..."

"You know something you're not telling me."

"No. Honestly, I ..."

"Margaret. You are an adult. But you are still living off me...you follow my rules. You live in Farmingham, but you're under my roof. I pay your tuition, I pay everything. Every bill you have, and there are a lot."

"I know, sir," she said, lowering her eyes.

"You know. So, there is no room for childish games."

"Father, I honestly don't know."

His eyes stuck on her coldly and he gripped his own chin. She was an adult. Spankings were over even though he thought she needed one. Laying a hand on your adult daughter's bottom was assault.

In that moment she felt shame. Hated it, hated that he could make her feel that way over something that had come about so organically. There was no shame in being with her two men. *Though it was more than two, wasn't it, Margaret?*

"Go to your room. You can come out at dinner," he said.

Standing weakly, she hesitated, wishing to say something, not knowing what to say. She didn't know why the video was gone. She couldn't answer him. The content of the video she did know. The things she had done that night began to weigh on her but it wasn't shame she felt. It was dishonor. Dishonoring her parents was tantamount to failure, a failure of oneself, and

in that moment something that had been welling up in her over the last few days bubbled right to the surface, oozing from her pores, spreading and pooling now on her like hot lava.

Pausing before she left, she turned and gripped the back of the chair on which she had been sitting.

“Father...I want...I was thinking of law school next year. I...was wondering about Harvard.”

Prowler

SATURDAY, OCTOBER 7TH

MARTIN AND CAROL had a dinner date with the Schlesinger's and they left together at 6 P.M. in a limousine. Maggie watched behind the large plate glass window that looked down from the library on the second floor; Martin escorting his lovely wife on his arm, handing her off to the driver who held the rear door open. Father in a fresh suit, steel gray as usual, mother in a black Gucci dress and low heels. The long black car crept the gravel, paused while the gate yawned open. When it left, the gate closed behind them, and she watched the dark yard, the gravel wet and glinting in the blue dusk.

She showered because her train was leaving early in the morning and she didn't want to hang around too long in the Becker mansion. Wanted to be home. Her dorm room and her Max were more her home than this place, and she missed them. With Strauss playing on her turntable she packed her bag hinged open on her bed.

A chime resounded, long, staccato beeps that indicated someone at the front gate. A visitor obviously, her parents returning knew the security code. Perhaps the Schlesingers, some mix-up in their scheduling...*I thought we were meeting at your place...*

There was a control panel in the hall outside her room, and she padded the stone floor in bare feet, touched the screen, said, "Hello?"

"Jamestown police," an official and deep voice simply said.

A dread shivered through her, a hydra of awful possibilities tumbling around in her mind. "Police?" she said into the microphone.

“Ma’am, we’d like to do a property check...there’s been a prowler reported in the area...”

A prowler? Did police still say that word? Now she was convinced this man was the prowler. “Well, hold on...” she said, thinking, searching—

“Have you received any disturbing calls, ma’am?”

—finding the cyan blue square that floated behind the black glass of the control panel, pressed it. A full color screen blossomed on the right of the display and she saw the vehicle stopped out front of the gate. Not a cop car, but a lifted white Jeep. One arm hung out the driver’s window while a face obscured in shadow talked into the intercom box.

“Why, yes,” she continued, “this man said awful things to me. I was so frightened. Can you trace the calls?”

“We did...”

“Where are they coming from?”

“Guess...”

“Please, don’t say inside the house...”

“Afraid so. You’ve got a bona fide sex pre-vert locked in there with you.”

“You’re the sex pervert,” she laughed. “Maxy with you?”

“You letting me in?”

“I’m probably safer with you out there,” she said and pressed the magenta square that opened the gate. Folding her arms, she pressed her back to the wall and twisted her mouth around. She was genuinely happy for company but that tightness had come back again...

She hoped Max was with him.

MAGGIE MET him at the door of the kitchen and he was alone.

“Max isn’t here?” she said, looking around him to the dark of the yard, beyond the cone of white light that shone from the halogen lamp above the door.

“Just me,” he said, stepping into the foyer.

Cole wore a charcoal suit. Sharp white dress shirt under that (white-only after six), and an expertly knotted tie in gunmetal silk. She was barefoot, yoga pants, baggy sweatshirt, wet hair that hung in dripping waves.

“You came by yourself?”

“Told you I missed you.”

“Cole...”

He walked to the island, leaned an elbow on the high counter and cocked his head at her. His long hair had been combed back behind his ears, but he hadn't shaved. “I'm only here to take you out for dinner,” he said with a smirk.

“What if my parents were home?”

“Friends go to dinner all the time. They don't know what we've done.”

“Shh-sh,” she shushed him, moved closer but kept the island between them.

“Someone home?” he said, putting both elbows on the counter and leaning near her. Their faces were level, extended over the countertop toward each other.

“No. But they have cameras. Maybe microphones.”

“Cameras?”

“Yeah. Did you...do anything to the security system?”

“What security system?” he laughed.

“You didn't erase any videos?”

“I wouldn't even know where to find them.”

She rubbed her arms and looked away for a moment. “Would Max?”

“And not tell you?”

“No, I suppose not. Then...Ken?”

“He didn't say a thing to us.”

“Would he? He was so odd that morning...”

“Hey,” he said, straightening. “Those things glitch all the time. How many people you seen freak out when their essay just disappears off their laptop?”

“Happened to me,” she murmured.

“You know those things fuck up all the time.” Now he held a hand out to her and smiled at her expectantly, waiting for her to take it.

She accepted it, found it easier than to stand there thinking of the things that her brother would have seen if he'd watched that video. But why would he watch the video? What would make him think to do it? It was nicer to believe father's security system shit the bed, as Max sometimes said. So she let her hand fall into Cole's big grip, and he walked her, their arms joined

above the counter, out of the kitchen and into the hall. Then she pulled her hand from him and whispered, "Cameras."

"Let's find you something to wear and get the hell out of here then," he said close and conspiratorially.

"Really?" she said, her voice with a high inflection.

He held both hands up, said, "Just dinner, Maggie."

She showed him a smirk, eyes narrowed, one corner of her mouth pulled up. "I have to dress up?"

His hands smoothed his tie, said, "I want you to dress like a lady."

"And how's that?"

He walked past her, down the hall and to the bottom of the stairs. "Let's explore your closet, Margaret. Let's find you some appropriate attire."

Leaning on the concrete wall, arms folded across her chest, she watched him mount the stairs and head to her bedroom. Confident and without the slightest trepidation.

It was just dinner.

It was her good friend Cole.

She followed warily behind him, but his pace was unfaltering. When she caught up with him in her bedroom he was already in her closet, indexing through her clothing admiringly.

"You have some lovely clothes, Margaret," he said, glancing her way, her standing outside her walk-in closet, a dozen feet away. Her hands had climbed up inside the sleeves of her sweatshirt and the soles of her feet had dampened.

Cole said, "Lovely things. Yet, all I ever see you in is...cotton."

"You don't like what I wear?"

He stopped his action, turned and regarded her with a hand on his hip. "You're always attractive, Maggie. Tonight I want to see my grown-up little girl. I want to see a woman."

Standing in the archway, she leaned against the frame, her legs crossing over, she said, "What are you doing, Cole?"

Ignoring her, though she could see the slightest of smirks trying to work on his face, he continued through her clothing, pulling the hanging items apart and regarding them. "Ah," he said, now taking a dress out, holding it by the hanger. "I would fucking kill to see you in this."

Under a thin film of frosted plastic was a black silk Prada dress she had worn only one time. Bought for a symphony she attended with her parents

two years ago in Boston. It was delicate and ethereal, sleeveless, with a low, scooped and ruffled neckline, black lace trim and a plissé pleated ankle-length skirt.

“I bet you would,” she said softly, averting her eyes from his gaze as she took the dress from him and held it to her, letting it fold in half over her arm.

“I know you want to show me.”

“Oh? Do I?”

“You’re being coy but I know you want me to see the real Margaret.”

“That’s what you think?” she said, smirking now, bold enough to look him in the eye.

“You want to show me, and I’m dying to see you in that dress. Just show me.”

They held each other’s gaze a long moment. Both of them unflinching. Both of them with clever little smiles. Hers showing she was onto his silly game and that she wasn’t backing down from him.

“If you insist,” she said, easing languidly off the frame.

Touching her wrist, he looked in her eyes and said, “Max can have you in white. When you’re with me, you wear black.”

She huffed, chuckled, held his gaze. “Why?”

He inhaled, speculated, let her wrist go and said, “There’s no mystery when we’re together. We both know what this is about.”

“I’m not fucking you tonight, Cole.”

An amused smile flashed instantly on his face, and he said, “I’m just taking you to dinner.”

She shook her head at him, looked him up and down in comical disdain and moved to the foot of her bed, tossing the dress on to it. She stopped.

This was where she would usually get undressed, but Cole was watching. He blocked the walk-in and she wouldn’t ask to get by him, it would display her weakness. She wouldn’t leave and go to her bathroom either for the same reason. She tried another tactic.

“You’re going to stand and watch, like a lecherous toad?”

“I’ve seen it all already, Margaret. I’ve seen it, held it, I’ve... There’s no shame between us...”

“Fine,” she said, but she gave him her back, took a deep breath and slipped her sweatshirt off over her head and tossed it up on her pillows. She was braless, and she held her forearm across her chest even though her back

was to him. Moving slowly, like this charade had no effect on her, she imagined him seeing the small muscles of her back working as she slipped her dress out of its protective cover using only one hand. Her nipples bunched against the underside of her forearm.

Shaking the dress out, she held it before her, pinched in both hands. Turned then, giving Cole a glance over her shoulder, making it sexy, knowing, (hoping), he might glimpse the profile of a bare breast. Such a dirty thought, but they'd been intimate before, seen each other naked before. Gosh, just the other night. What would he think seeing her nipple so swollen?

Cole watched, leaning now on the door frame as she had, arms folded, eyes narrowed by a confident smirk.

"Getting a good look?" she said.

"Taking it all in."

She laughed so he could hear it, tossing the dress over her head and shimmying herself into it til the skirt fell to her ankles. Still with her back to him, she lifted the skirt and tucked her hands underneath, thumbed under the waistband of her yoga pants and slipped them down, thrusting her hips from side-to-side until she could step out of them. As she threw them on the bed he said, "Turn for me. Let me see you."

She complied, turning a tight circle til she faced him, rolled her eyes, cocked a hip and slipped a hand up on her waist.

"You are the most perfect woman I have ever seen."

"Flattery," she said.

He crossed to her, a slow and steady clop of his dress shoes on the hard floor as he closed the distance. She tingled watching him, every bit of her working up a playful swagger so he wouldn't catch her swooning. One eyebrow went up, and she tried not to burst into a giggle as he drew up so close she had to tilt her head to look in his eyes. She was in her bare feet, he was tall and masculine, fully dressed, his shining shoes touching her tiny toes. It made her feel a wash of prickly vulnerability and she cleared her throat; wanting to say something but finding herself at a loss for words.

"Turn again for me," he said. She did, going around in a complete circle, the other direction, but twisting a gaze over her shoulders as she did, wanting to see his eyes on her.

"Hm," he grunted as she made her way to face him again.

"What?" she said.

His hands came to her hips, his fingers walking her skirt higher, gathering the material up in his hands. The hem of her dress danced and tickled up her shins, up over her knees. When it touched the middle of her thighs, starting a tremor in her stomach, she said, "What are you doing?"

The skirt rose higher and higher, he smiled, said, "Your panty line is showing."

"No, it's not," she said, lowering her brows.

His fingertips touched her bare skin, grazing the sides of her tummy at the low hollow where it met her hips. She flinched strongly, gasped, whispered, "Hey."

His fingers slipped under the waistband.

"He-ey," she whispered again, and she put her hands over his. "What are you doing?"

His fingers stayed, unmoving, warm. They pulsed with life but were held immobile as they both looked deep into each other's eyes.

Finally, he softened, smiled, withdrew his hands, put them in his pockets and stepped back.

They still stared at one another, eyes darting, both of them stifling wider smiles, holding back lusty breath. At last, she slipped her panties down, underneath her skirt, stepped her feet out of them, held them wadded up in her fist and presented them to him.

"You want these ones in your pocket too?"

He sneered unevenly, and she tossed the panties into a laundry hamper by her dresser with a soft whomp.

She giggled now, breaking the spell, pulled her wet hair back from her face and said, "What should I do about my hair?"

"Pulled back like that it shows how beautiful you are."

"Tie it back?"

"Yes," he said, turned and made his way to her closet again. "Let's find you some shoes. Something with a heel."

Trothplight

SATURDAY, OCTOBER 7TH

SHE WATCHED their reflection in the glass atrium as they descended the stairs together. It was black night outside now, the interior of the home lit with warm ambient light, and two finely dressed, beautiful people walked hand in hand; ghostly, pale mirror reflections. Her hand was in his because her heels were high. Cole had picked for her the tallest heel in her closet. A pair of shoes that, like the dress, had been bought for an event and worn only one time. Five-inch Gucci heels she had gladly let hide in the back of her closet because at that event, Yo-Yo Ma at the Lincoln Center in New York City, she had come seriously close to toppling in front of Manhattan's elite. She'd stumbled but her father caught her. Sixteen-years-old then, a woman now. Now she would wear heels and she would learn to walk in them. However, the concrete steps in her home were daunting.

At the bottom of the stairs he held his arm out to take her, she smirked, rolled her eyes again, looped hers under his and let him escort her through the kitchen.

"I haven't worn these heels in almost five years," she said as she clicked across the stone and towards the door at the back of the kitchen that led to the gravel drive. "I think I'm doing all right."

"You are, Maggie. You really look stunning. I'm thinking I should have picked a shorter dress. I want to see those legs in heels."

"Oh, please..."

"Don't worry. I'm not terribly disappointed. I know what's under there. I'd just like to watch those muscles work."

They stopped at the door out of the kitchen. Ahead, dimly lit, just out of the reach of the light above the door, Cole's lifted Jeep reflected back dully. On their right stood the hall table, black and angular, on top, a crystal Baccarat Damier bowl. Cole reached in the bowl, hooked the fob for father's SL in his forefinger and winked to her, said, "I think we'll take the Mercedes tonight, Margaret."

"Oh...I don't know," she said.

"I could always turn up the keys for the Spyder..."

She laughed at the thought, said, "Oh man, Martin would cut those big balls of yours right off."

Cole shrugged it off, said, "It is a really amazing car. A classic. I'd love to try it out. Where do you think he keeps the keys?"

Cole was looking at her with serious intent, but he was fooling. She knew that look. He was teasing her. Truth was, if she had decided to go out on her own tonight she would have taken her father's SL. Or her mother's Porsche. She wasn't much of a driver, only got her license over the summer when she turned eighteen. Had hardly ever driven at all, maybe a few thousand miles in her whole life, but just the same, her father wasn't precious with his day-to-day vehicles. No, he wouldn't have even batted an eye if she'd gone out to see a movie on her own and took his car.

She said, "Let's just take the Mercedes tonight, darling," and she put her arm under his again and held herself close to him, keeping a straight face as long as she could before she burst out with the giggles. "I like your balls exactly where they are."

IT WAS on the Bellevue Road that the bad feeling came to her. A prickly green wave of worry settled over her as she considered where he might take her. They had driven through Jamestown, crossed the Newport Bridge, but now they had slipped south of Newport City and were heading into Aquidneck proper. Then they were zipping along the narrow mansion-lined Ruggles Road, and she knew there weren't any restaurants ahead, except, of course, one of the finest in the area lying ahead on the Cliff Walk.

The Mercedes hummed along the macadam at low speed; the radio tuned to Sirius's classical station. Light from the GPS and the digital

dashboard lit up Cole's chiseled face from below. He was steady-eyed, stoic, looking a lot like a male model in this dramatic light, with his brushed back hair and his stubbled jaw with pouting strawberry red lips.

"Where are you taking me?" she whispered just above the volume of Stravinsky from the speakers.

He smiled, his eyes darting over to regard her without turning his head.

"Cole? ..."

"I told you I'm taking you to dinner..."

"Cole... Where? ..."

"A lovely restaurant where I know the food is excellent." Now he was smiling again, the slightest meanness twisting one corner of his mouth higher than the other.

"Please, no, Cole..."

"Oh yes, Margaret. The Poirot."

A fizzling pulse of anger sparked within her but it faded under a sadness. The knowledge she would surrender extinguished it. She knew she wouldn't turn him away from this, and if she wouldn't, well how bad was it really?

"The place where I'm getting married?" she whined, her heavy shoulders slumping, her back hunching.

"You're not getting married..."

"Oh, I'm not?"

"Not there. It's just your reception..."

"You know what I mean..."

"Lighten up, Margaret," he laughed, let his head fall back lazily against the headrest while his eyes stayed on the road. Up ahead, their headlights shone on the open gate set in the stone walls of the mansion's perimeter, boughs of buxus above in undulating clumps. "If you're a good girl...a lucky girl...I might slurp *your* oyster tonight."

She laughed, shook her head, smirking, reached out without looking and held his hard forearm just below his elbow. She squeezed him lightly, amiably, sighed, "You're such an asshole."

His other hand gripped her fingers against him and he leaned his head and kissed the back of her hand.

The car wound up the switchback driveway, climbing towards the dazzling, amber-lit mansion, stopped under the carport and a valet held the car door open for her. Cole took her hand as the SL drove off, and they

walked the red carpet towards the brass double doors that would take them into the Poirot. She stopped him on the first step and he followed her gaze out to the horizon. The mansion sat high on the cliff and looked out over Sheep Point Cove. The water thrashed in choppy black and silver, and the sky was a deep and endless amaranthine, almost unblemished. She smiled and sighed. Though she felt a little robbed by this preview of her wedding night, she knew she was glad to be here.

"WELL, this is a different Cole I'm seeing tonight," she said after he had ordered a bottle of Chianti, a Fattoria di Petroio Classic Reserve.

Folding his hands together over the linen place mat he leaned forward, said, "I just want to have fun tonight, Maggie. I want to enjoy you as a woman. Ten months from now you will marry my best friend, but until then..."

"Enjoy me as a woman?" she said with pleasant snideness.

He leaned back, irritated, raised his eyebrows. "Listen...you're my best friend's girl, and I never took a sideways look at you. Least one you or Max saw...but you're crazy if you don't think I thought about it."

"That's nice," she said, feeling herself soften. "What did you think about me?"

"Think I'm your friend cause your Max's girl? Know how many my dudes who have girlfriends make me want to stab my brain with a pen? ... Well, you get the point. They aren't like you. I'm your friend because I genuinely like you. On a profound level, Maggie."

"And what about Max?"

"What do you mean?"

"You care about Max but you brought me here."

"It's not allowed? If this is so wrong, Maggie, tell me..."

"No...no, I don't think so..."

"It's not. You and I are friends. I mean that. You're the only girl I ever liked because I...liked her. I spend time with girls it's to fuck them. I hang out with you all the time and never made a move."

"If you liked me all this time, in that way...then, yes, that is very respectable."

“Right. And now I feel like there’s something on the table and I’d be crazy not to make a grab for it.”

“What do you mean? *I’m* on the table?”

“All three of us are friends. We all care about each other. What about me? Maybe I should get something here. Maybe it’s been my fantasy to date you. Take you out and—”

“That’s too much.”

“No, it’s not. I don’t think it is. How about this? ...I know the arrangement you have, you and Max, and I get it, but what if I told you Max is manipulating you?”

“How?”

“He’s doing this for his own...titillation.”

The waiter interrupted them, a sommelier at his side. The wine was poured, Cole approved, though she was sure he wouldn’t know to disapprove unless it was vinegar. But he was unafraid of the show, unafraid to let seasoned wait staff watch him sample the wine and nod, going through the theater that was fine dining. He had volumes of confidence and he looked good doing it. He ordered for her, picking Wild Boar because it went with the Chianti. They started with Nasturtium Risotto and he ordered a Tuna Carpaccio as well. Oysters were clearly on the menu and she was relieved when he avoided them. She wasn’t confident enough for a performance tonight, and her heart wouldn’t be into slurping an oyster held out for her, nor watching him slurp one held by her. Though she was quite sure his reference in the vehicle was a comically vulgar one and he was insinuating the oyster between her thighs.

When the waiter left she was eager to continue, and she leaned forward again and quietly said, “Titillation?”

“Tell me I’m wrong,” he said.

“I don’t know. I’ve been having fun.”

“He’s very focused on what he gets out of this, though he bills it as you exploring the things you may have missed. If he truly cares you are fulfilled before he ties the knot with you, challenge him. Ask him for the things you’ve been curious about.”

“It’s not a free for all, Cole. I can’t go...” she whispered, “like, suck off the football team or something.”

“That what you want?” He smirked, cocked an eyebrow.

“Don't be stupid. I mean there's rules. We haven't described them but we're fucked if we don't know what they are without talking about it. I'm allowed to explore but of course we do it together. Max gets something out of it. I *want* him to get something out of it.” Now she leaned closer, whispered again, told him earnestly, “I *like* that he gets something out of it.”

Cole nodded and sighed. His gaze cast the room, mildly regarding the other diners while his mind went to work.

She said, “What do you think of me now? Do you think that's weird? Do you think I'm weird?”

“No way. No way. Not at all. But don't you ever wonder what it would be like to be with another man, without Max watching? Not sex, or not just sex, but I mean, the full experience. Unhindered.”

“I guess. But...”

“Secret Society, Maggie, remember? We should do this.”

“This what?”

“Together. All three of us. For you. But let me...let me be a part of it, let—”

“You don't think you're a part of it?” she laughed.

“Don't let Max tell you what you want. You tell us what you want. We'll show you. I'll show you.”

“You want me to cheat on Max.”

“I want you to know what it would be like to be with a man who knows what he's doing, without the sex being a performance of some kind.”

Now she sighed, and her elbows went on the table, her hands clasped together, and she bit the knuckle of her thumb. She said, “I tell Max a lot more than you know. I tell him what I want. He wants to know those things.”

“Well, tell me.”

“No way.”

“Yeah, I know already,” he said, leaning back in his chair. A lock of his shaggy blonde hair fell free, and he smoothed it back. Farther from the table, without the light from the candle's glow, his teeth shone white between his berry-colored lips.

“Why don't you tell me then?” she laughed.

“We both know what you want.”

She laughed lightly, choked it off, lowered her eyes to her fidgeting hands. She'd folded and creased the corner of her napkin until it was a

twisted whorl.

She hid the napkin away, tucked it down to her lap. She whispered, "You don't think I'm weird?"

"Maggie, if I didn't think it would freak you the fuck out I'd tell you I love you."

"Don't."

"Not like that. But...I do."

"Okay. Don't say that."

"I didn't. I won't. But I want you to trust me."

"I do. I care about you too."

"I know you do."

Cole leaned to the table again, his forearms across the crisp place mat, his wineglass jostling, the chianti swirling, sending hypnotic blood-red cycloids dancing on the linen.

He said, "I know what you want, Maggie."

"You don't think...I'm...dirty..."

"No way... In a bad way? ..."

"Yeah, like...a...slut? ..."

"Whoah," he sighed. "That's a bad word. That's heavy."

"It is."

"Why would you ever say that?"

"I don't know." She shrugged.

"Does Max call you that?"

"I don't want to talk about Max anymore."

Max called her that because she liked it. But he also called her that because it turned him on. How would she explain that to Cole? Explain it without mentioning Jay and the things she did with him. Did for Max. Did for herself too, but in concert with her man. The twisted part of their sexuality was gripping tighter and tighter, and the further they explored the more complicated it became, and soon they would be tightened right up like the corner of her napkin. There was a fear in her of what Max might want next. Afraid that she wouldn't have the sense to say no.

Cole took her hand, watched her patiently from across the table, over top the deep orange bouquet of greenhouse marigolds. She said, "Tell me. Tell me, Cole. Tell me what I want."

"Let me show you, Maggie."

The reality of his words were jarring, and she slipped her hand away from his. "I can't, Cole."

"Tell me you don't want to."

"No."

"Honestly, Maggie...look in my eyes."

She resisted, rolled her eyes around mildly, averting them, doing everything to avoid looking at him. She jumped when she felt his hand on hers again. Warm, large, covering hers. She looked at it, looked at the veins, the big knuckles. He had large and well-formed hands. So masculine, but not dirtied with labor. The skin a healthy tan.

"Look in my eyes, Maggie," he said softly.

So she did. Looked over the flickering candlelight and right into his shimmering blue eyes.

"What, Cole?" she whispered. "Of course I want to. You know that."

"I know that."

"Of course I want to," she repeated and looked away again before the foundation of her resolve crumbled under his waves. He still held her hand, his thumb running along her wrist. He was still holding her hand when their food arrived.

Regency

SATURDAY, OCTOBER 7TH

SHE WOULDN'T MEET her own eyes in the mirror. Avoiding her reflection, she washed her hands in the spotless bathroom where she had gone during their food tasting last weekend. Outside the heavy wooden door, she knew Cole would be waiting.

She'd left him at the table to settle the bill and came in and pressed a cold paper towel to her cheeks, digging her fingers into the muscles under her eyes. Touched up her makeup then, her amber eyes darting over the Maggie in the mirror and unsettling her. How would she stop them from doing something that would be a mistake? They were helplessly tumbling that way. Cole cleared everything from her path, let her see him put cushions along the route and she knew, if she wasn't careful, they would end up tumbling into her bedroom. *How terrible would that be?*

On a scale of 1 to 10, it was a nine. It was Max's greatest fear. He'd told her. They wouldn't laugh at him but it was without him. Just the other night they'd already gone too far, and in the aftermath she could feel her brain struggling to make it okay, twist her indiscretion into something that would be for Max's erotic benefit. She could do it now too. Tell herself that as hurtful as it would be to sleep with his best friend, her loving Max would reap a benefit. How would she reveal it to him? In bed, maybe riding him...? She could picture that, getting on top of him, his hands on her breasts, she could control their lovemaking and tell him every detail. He would love it. In a way it would be for him, it would be a present she could slowly unwrap for him.

“Shit,” she sighed, grasping her neck with both hands and boldly looking at her slutty face now. Where Maggie? At home? Your parents will be there. In your dad’s precious Mercedes? Bad idea. The Poirot would be booked. Where else? Find a hotel somewhere along the way? They needed to knock this off. Quit it. Put the jets in reverse and blast back some of this forward momentum before they both did something they regretted.

She snatched her clutch off the marble counter and opened the door. He was there. Waiting. Posing as he was last weekend. It had been okay then. Why not now? Really...why?

His uneven smile made her toes clench inside the points of her Gucci’s. Easing off the high, marble-topped table, he crossed the hall to her. She didn’t smile, just watched every move he made the whole painstaking voyage to her. They met face to face, her taller in her heels than she had been the last time they’d come together in this hall. It was quiet in here, but from the restaurant side they could hear the murmur of patrons, the clink of silver on china. He leaned to her, his hand going over her shoulder again, palm against the wall to her right. She sucked her lips into her mouth and looked deep into his eyes. He kissed her. Slow and delicate, his lips came in and took command of her. She softly grunted, her head tilting back weakly on her neck as she succumbed her lips, succumbed her heart. Hands staying at her sides, one elbow bent to hold her clutch tucked to her waist. His mouth worked on hers, soft lips suckling and biting at her, rough beard scratching her porcelain skin. She moaned into his mouth and the sound broke her in two.

“No. Cole, don’t, please,” she whimpered. Her eyes swelled with the threat of tears.

The tickle of her hem being lifted danced up one shin, across her knee. He stared in her eyes and she didn’t stop him. She bit her lip and in her mind she had the strength to say stop, had the power to say no. The hem danced up her thigh and neither of them wavered, their eyes locked on one another, not even darting suspiciously up and down the hall to make sure they weren’t discovered. Her hand moved to his wrist. Felt his cuff, his cufflink, gripped him but didn’t stop him. His fingers touched the bare skin of her thigh and she gasped. Then he ran them higher, up underneath her dress, dancing along the hollow again in the space where her hip met her tummy. It fluttered, and she held her breath.

When he finally touched her her knees gave for a moment and she bobbed, her eyes went lazy and in that moment he took her kiss again and she let him, her head tilted back until the crown touched the wall, his finger stroking through her wetness, dipping inside her body.

She let him finger her, his other hand moved up her back, gripped her neck. He fucked her deeply with his finger, alternately kissing her, then looking deep and longingly into her eyes.

“Stop, stop, stop,” she whispered desperately, though if he continued she may have just urged that too. She felt so lost, so twisted. “We can’t,” she cried, and now a single tear spilled from an eye and down her cheek. He brushed it away with a knuckle.

“Come with me,” he said, and he took her hand, let her dress fall. She followed along with him as a party of six came through the double doors ahead of them, laughing and regaling, oblivious to the exciting show they missed by a second.

They passed through the doors at the end of the hall, under the staircase and balcony above, to find themselves in the lobby of the Poirot. It was at one time the dining room of the mansion before it was renovated as a hotel, and reception was on their right. The concierge was a pretty woman in her thirties, blonde hair pulled back in a tight bun, wearing a dark suit; sitting by herself behind an ornate walnut table with carved, double-scroll legs. A fire in the fireplace next to her crackled.

The room was extravagant, but small and intimate and they had her attention.

“Mr. Cantarella,” she said, nodding to Cole.

Instead of walking left and taking her out to retrieve the Mercedes and take her home, he pulled her to the right, towards the staircase that rose to the balcony above.

“Cole,” she whispered. This was crazy. They would be booked, and what if they recognized her here?

She stumbled along with him, smiling, but tucking her chin down and hiding her face from the woman. They passed her, came to the bottom of the stairs that led to the mansion’s second floor, turned and mounted the first step.

She stopped him. “Where are we going, Cole?”

“Come on, Maggie. Come with me.”

She threw a glance to the concierge but stopped, afraid their eyes may actually meet. Turned her head away and came up next to him as he continued to ascend the old wooden stairs carpeted in rich pile.

She whispered, "Cole, where are we going?"

"We have a room."

"A room? No, Cole. How did you get a room?"

"I got us a room."

"How?" she whispered, her tension turning it to a hiss.

"I booked it last week."

"Cole," she sighed, her brows going high in the middle, her face twisting like she might cry, but her feet kept pace with him. At the top of the stairs she panicked, yanked his arm when they were out of sight of anyone.

She frowned deep, said, "Not the Bridal Suite?"

He shook his head, his eyes soft and caring. "No, Maggie. No. I wouldn't do that."

His hands went to both sides of her neck and he held her. Her hands went over his and she looked in his eyes hoping he would be the one to come to his senses first.

THEIR ROOM WAS the Regency Suite, and it looked out over the garden and then the black of the ocean beyond. The room was paneled in rich oak, set with complex linenfold. A leather couch sat in front of a fireplace and the fire was already crackling, lighting the dim room in rolling amber hues. Past the fireplace and the couch, the room raised two steps and there were the windows that looked out to the water, and a balcony with four chairs. On one side, in the raised half, was an enormous oak four-post bed with a canopy, clad in rich bunting and a drape that undulated over top. On the right loomed a massive oak armoire with heavy curved legs, and to the right of that a bathroom door, slightly ajar, and she could see it was tiled in rich, chocolaty marble.

Cole's hand pressed on the small of her back, urging her farther into the room. She took another step forward, and he closed the door behind them. When his hands embraced the narrow of her waist she moved away again,

deeper into the room, pausing at the couch, dropping her clutch on the arm, then laying her hands over the cushioned backrest.

“I can’t do this, Cole,” she whispered.

“We’ll tell him when we’re done. We’ll sit him down and we’ll break it to him.”

“No, Cole.”

“We won’t hurt him, I swear, Maggie. He’ll be okay.”

“I don’t know if he would be...”

His hands rested on her again and this time she didn’t have the strength to walk away. She felt their warmth, their size, how small and slim they made her. His presence behind her was enormous, this looming thing hunting her down, a predator so powerful its prey succumbed, threw itself down and exposed its neck, hoping the other animal would make it quick. Though tonight Cole was no bloodthirsty predator—he’d brought her here by cunning rather than physical prowess—he had those abilities too. No, her being in this room was less about Cole’s predatory skills and more about her willingness, desire, to thrust her jugular up to be taken. She tilted her head, exposed her neck, literally, to him. He kissed her and her toes gripped the soles of her shoes again, her girl parts tightened and a spate of sweat rose interiorly.

“I will give you what you want. I’ll give you what he can’t.”

“Cole...”

“Do you love Max?”

“I love him so much.”

“Does he love you?”

“I know he does.”

“Let it happen, Maggie. Let it happen.”

Now his hands dipped lower, sliding the palms down over the curve of her slim hips, angling to her bottom. It hit her like electricity. His touch on her ticklish and sensitive spot brought something terrible to life.

“Oh, don’t,” she sighed.

A tragic and overwhelming wave passed over her and she found the strength to stumble away from him. She crossed the room, her hand clutching her warm forehead. Her heart beat a rapid pulse up the sides of her neck. Moving from him, from the fire, she walked to the raised half of the room, her heels quiet now on a velvety carpet. Between the armoire and the bed, in the rough hand-stuccoed space between the two windows there

was a dresser with a mirror and she paused there, put her hands on the cool, wooden top and bowed her head before her reflection.

His footsteps approached and her heart rate quickened. When they fell silent on the carpet he was close. Chin tilting upward, eyes forced to raise, she watched him then—growing larger in the mirror, coming over her shoulder. His hands were in his pockets, the warm hue of the fire lit him from behind, putting an orange line that drew his masculine silhouette. The ambient light from the night swimming in the two windows cut cold shadows on the stubbled hollows of his cheeks, his sharp jawline. His eyes were dark, unreadable.

Cole in the mirror was the one who put her insides on fire. Her good friend... He was a boy she loved as a friend but in the mirror she could glimpse the man he would become. And while she loved him as a friend, and only as a friend, she was afraid she might be in love with that man he would be. A devastating fear that, while she loved Max now, it would be Cole she loved in the future.

His body touched hers and she shivered, closed her eyes. Slowly her skirt was being raised, the hem lightly dancing up her calves, touching the ticklish backs of her knees.

She opened her eyes, saw his gaze lowered, looking at her bare legs as they were revealed. Muscles tensing, toes pivoting, she posed her legs for him, showed him what he wanted, what he'd asked for. He admired her legs and the look in his eyes, one of deep appreciation and fondness, burst her. She bit the inside of her mouth.

The hem came higher.

Her calves flexed, the muscles raising and arcing; still she watched his eyes. The hem slipped up over the curve of her bare rump and her breath stuck in her chest. Her heart beat loud in her eardrums.

One hand held her skirt at the small of her back, the other touched her skin and she gasped. The sound of her arousal made him bolder. He caressed the cheeks of her ass, each globe such a small thing in his masculine spread. A finger slipped between her legs and she gasped again. Her ankles twisted sideways in her shoes as she spread her legs just a little wider, just enough for him to slip a fingertip along her sex.

“Do you know how wet you are?”

She nodded quickly, her head turned to the side, keeping him in her periphery, but her gaze cast down.

“Such a naughty Margaret. My little girl didn’t even wear her panties tonight.”

She shook her head no, desperate for more of his touch, wanting his finger sinking inside her again. It slipped back and forth, each oily grazing tingling the top of her scalp and making her feet feel like they were leaving the floor.

“I’m such a bad girl,” she whispered.

“You are,” he agreed. Then he found her tight, wet aperture, and she felt his wonderful parting, his finger pushing her flesh aside and her body accepted him, wanted him. He worked her like that, touching, teasing, fucking her. Her sex made wet and excited sounds. She lifted her whole body up on her toes—avoided the mirror, but flashed a look at his handsome face when she was strong. He watched her face in the mirror while he pleased her. Every time she glanced his eyes were on hers, waiting for them to open. His eyes were confident, dominant, and they made her eager to be his plaything, eager to find out the pleasure he might give her if she didn’t stop him.

Reaching back, she took her own hem now, lifted her skirt high for him, bent at the waist and showed him the round curve of her ass. Their eyes met again but this time she held his gaze. Eyes flashing over one another, her lips sucked into her mouth, she screamed to him what she wanted, what she deserved, at the same time as her mouth choked off the words. Silently screaming with her pleading expression. Her chest heaved with wanton breath; he’d brought a high and bright shine to her, white light running in a warbling line along the raised blades of her collar and neck.

One strong hand gripped her narrow wrist, held her palm firmly pressed to the dresser top, her mouth falling agape. She lifted her skirt higher, her brows raising to a peak in the middle.

His open hand drew back and her knees trembled... He slapped her ass hard and she cried out. A high and thin feminine sound, not pain but an exultation. Her head nodded so slightly for him. He slapped her ass again, harder, the sound sharper. Her flesh shook, her thin thighs jiggled. “Oh,” she cried out again, and her tummy tightened, her sex flexed, a warm wetness trickled on the inside of her thighs. Now he gripped her ass cheek, coddled it and smoothed it, his eyes on hers in the mirror.

“Again,” she whispered. “Eight more.”

He kept her eyes, his expression even and unwavering. His hand drew back again, and he struck her hard across her bottom. The pain was white and bright, rippling an electric tingle across her skin, making her numb from her cheeks to the backs of her knees. He struck her hard four more times, making her yelp with each one. He never wavered. His eyes stayed locked on her, his brow lowered, not in meanness but in determination.

“Am I...” she gasped, paused, “Am I a...disappointment?”

A cocky smile pulled up one corner of his mouth, denting his cheek. “We’re going to set you straight tonight, Margaret. We’re going to teach you a lesson.”

“Yeah,” she softly cried.

He finished. A silver cuff link winked in the firelight each time his hand drew back, becoming a liquid blur as it sped towards her flesh. Ten times he spanked her. Ten times his masculine hand came in contact with her innocent and misunderstood flesh. Each strike an erotic plunge through her heart and brain. She hated that Max couldn’t do this. Hated that she wanted it. Loved that she had a man who could do this to her insides.

When the count ended at ten he released her wrist and helped her to straighten. Then he kissed the hollow of her neck and she melted into him.

Couch

SATURDAY, OCTOBER 7TH

“KEEP YOUR HEELS ON,” he said. “I want you naked. I want you in heels.”

She nodded at his reflection. Their eyes met again in the mirror and he worked her skirt higher, his hand gathering up its generous length; then he gripped it, raised the dress. Slowly her thighs were revealed, higher, the cleft of her tight shaved mound, glistening in the light. Higher still, showing her tummy, her tight navel...she cocked a hip, admired herself. Raising her arms, the dress came up, revealed her pink nipples, darkened to rose, hardened to taut buds. The fabric caught on one and as it pulled free sent the lightest jiggle through her meagre bosom. Then he had it off, and she was bare.

She pressed her back to him, felt the fabric of his suit, the strength of the body it concealed. His eyes worked up and down her naked form and it swelled her nipples painfully. Breath shallow and rapid, her eyes fluttered.

“Look at my beautiful little girl,” he said, a hand coming and tracing along her waist, up her ribs, cupping one breast. He smiled again, suckled at the nape of her neck. Her legs were on the verge of collapse. She was naked, pressed against his hard body, the rough fabric scratching at her soft skin. All she wore were her high heels, a thin Cartier watch, silver bracelets, and a diamond necklace her aunt and uncle had bought her for graduating high school.

Through narrowed eyes she watched herself held in her friend’s arms. Cole made her so thin and feminine. His arms went around her middle, hugged her tighter to him, his hardness against her back. Teeth bit and

tugged at her flesh and she raised her arms for him, her nipples tightening painfully. She ran her hands through his hair and he cupped a breast, his thumb and forefinger testing her nipple's arousal. She was falling to him, surrendering. The weight of her body slumped against him and he held her, supported her. She watched in the mirror as he lifted her, one arm across her stomach, the other scooping under her tender rump and supporting her like she sat in a saddle. He walked them backwards, she watched the couple in the mirror, in love with their abandon and the young girl's sweet surrender.

At the foot of the tall grand bed there was a deep-brown, walnut and leather couch, and he sat on it, her back to his chest, she straddled his lap. One of his knees forced her legs wide, and she found herself split over only one of his thighs. Her hands came together between her legs and covered herself demurely. She felt her heat, her own oily wetness. Idly fingering her own folds she waited to see what he would do to her.

He brushed her hands away, annoyed, and she folded them across her tummy. His other hand took her throat, pulled her so she lay against him, her back on his chest, the crown of her head in the hollow of his shoulder. Her legs were open, one on either side of his right thigh, her heels planted apart, bestriding his polished shoe. Her head turned to him, she gazed into his eyes with longing and he kissed her again, and as their lips went over one another, his hand found its way between her legs, stroking and plucking at her folds. When his finger dipped deeply inside her again, she cried out into his mouth.

His back braced against the footboard of the massive bed, she lay heavily against him, legs split, his hand working her soaking sex. The fire crackled and spit, and his manipulations made their own crackling sounds. Feverishly, he worked her...then slowed, smoothed her. Her heart pounded, raced so fast she would run out of breath...then he would ease. Soon he had her writhing against him, so close to coming that if she didn't get it, she would scream. He kept promising her release then reneging, letting her pleasure wash away only to tease it forward, hungry and ready again. Knees bowing in and out, she panted, and he kissed her and bit her shoulder.

When he had her flat tummy bending in and out, rolling round then dropping flat, in and out like the Narragansett waves outside the window, he unzipped himself. She watched. Watched his fine hand pull the tab, heard the finely tailored sizzle as his fly released. Hand working in the flaps, he pulled out the thing she wanted. When he let it go it stuck up hard and eager

from the open front of his fly. Glorious, erect, threateningly thick; the foreskin hung up crooked on the corona of his swollen glans.

Her hand reached out to it and when her small grip tried circling his size, he moaned and bit her collar. He had her moaning now too, and she began to stroke him, enjoying the effect her hand had on the shape of his cock while he resumed his plunging. He was rock hard and the hot feel of him had her biting both her lips into her mouth. The things he was doing to her between her legs had her movements clumsy and stunted in no time. Her stroke on his cock grew uneven, pausing, squeezing, going underhanded. Finally she released him, both hands flat on her tummy as he fucked her with his two middle fingers. Her pussy made sounds of suction and greasy bubbling. Her face pinched to an open-mouth scowl. She drew her knees up, her expensive heels lifting right off the floor. Cole was about to make her come. She rocked back and forth, her head slowly nodding and snapping back, and the things Cole did to her were bringing something huge and gargantuan; a rolling super-wave coming to shore in the night, a stormy breeze lashing at her, threatening to tear her hatches...

MAX WATCHED Cole make his Maggie scream in orgasm from a gap in the open door of the armoire. It was beautiful, and if his heart weren't so clutched, he may have enjoyed it better.

The orgasm began slowly, building with precision. He watched his best friend dig his fingers inside her, eyes darting over her, reading her expression. Then Cole worked her. Worked her like he'd worked probably a hundred girls, using all his acquired skills to deliver pleasure to Maggie that she may never have had before. It was forbidden and taboo. So wrong. And that dirty depth gave her pleasure scale. This was his gift to her. Max gifted Cole's abilities to Maggie.

Slowly, Maggie became an instrument on Cole's lap. She was naked, him clothed. His sweet girl straddling one of his thighs, her legs open, her mound pushed forward hungrily. Cole fed it. Fed it his big fingers and their experienced touch.

Her legs began to wind in and out, her expression became forlorn and simultaneously winsome. Her beauty was perfect. There had never been a

more exquisitely formed face. He ached for her.

Cole's cock came out. Thick and impressive. Maggie watched it in her grip; the thing so thick her dainty hand only formed a C around it. She explored it, stroked it. Her action grew clumsy as Cole brought her to a magnificent precipice. Her face closed off, her eyes squeezed shut. That face told him something huge was building. Her lips pursed, her cheeks ballooned. Then her thin legs were kicking up, feet coming off the floor. She screamed a long cry as she came, twisted on him, her thighs clamped shut on his hand. He still controlled her, held her to him and let her squirm. His hand still manipulated her, still stroked and moved even though she had him clenched tight. She was gasping and sobbing happily, a high whine whistling in her heaving breaths.

Cole held her until her movement stilled, and all that remained of her orgasm was the rapid rising and falling of her chest. She had grown a shine that shimmered like velvet in the fire's light and he couldn't imagine a more perfect image of his fiancée.

Cole brought her awake again with kisses. Starting at her ear, along her jaw, he got her head roused, her chin pointing up so she would let him take her lips. They kissed again. Maggie's arms were lazy and uncoordinated, still reeling from the incredible orgasm their friend had delivered to her. One hand played over the back of his as it still held her between her legs. The other arm bent, the hand up, her fingers scratching through his long hair that had fallen free from its brushed control.

The hand between her legs slowly came up. It shone from Maggie's sexual excitement. He had her incredibly wet. But she was a sexual girl and prone to sexual flux. His middle finger drew a line up her belly leaving a slippery trail that shone back to Max. The finger traveled higher, between her breasts, along her collar, up the long tendon of her neck. He put it in her mouth and she sucked. She did it sensually, her eyes closed, her sharp jaw angled, posed, trying to look good for Cole while she performed. She sucked his finger as impressively as she'd done that night on the beach when she'd sucked his cock.

MAGGIE SLUMPED IN HIS LAP. Her body drifting down his, like she was growing heavy or tired. Her face twisted with something sad, and it struck him that she was reluctant to do the things she was doing. And was going to do.

The restraints that bound her to her Max had come unshackled, and for the evening Maggie belonged to his best friend. That sadness in her face made his heart call to her. He wished he could go to her, tell her it was all right. Tell her to enjoy it, but that was against the point. So he watched her slide between Cole's legs, her back passing over his crotch, and she sat her bare butt on the floor, mournful eyebrows bowed, her knees poking up, her ankles twisted in the highest heels he'd ever seen her wear. One of her hands played with a bangle on the opposite wrist. Then she was turning, legs folding, her head coming around between Cole's legs. His cock stuck up straight and hard and she ran her tongue up the underside.

"Oh fuck, Margaret, that little tongue..."

She continued to bathe him, letting her tongue explore his shape. Traveling from where it emerged from his fly, up to the tip, poking into his hole and then slipping right back down.

"That's it, Margaret," Cole encouraged. "Get it so wet. You want it wet when I fuck you?"

She nodded, her mouth coming up to the top again, slipping over his glans and tugging on his foreskin with her lips.

"Suck it, Margaret. I've never had a blowjob like the one you gave me last week. That's it, suck it," he said and now his hands came to her head and braced her, guiding her down his shaft.

"I thought about that blowjob all week long," he sighed as Maggie worked him. She went up and down, making wet slurping and suckling noises. She was on her knees before him. Servicing him. Completely naked except for heels and jewelry, and the sight of her like that, the woman he loved so much, had his heart pounding and his cock as hard as steel. She was so incredible.

Her hands came up, stroked his shaft as she bobbed on just the glans now, plopping up and down, his foreskin rolling and drawing. Cole let his legs stretch out a little as he lost some of his control. Maggie's mouth was unbelievable; like she loved to perform the act. Cole reeled it in, struggled to keep his power over his sexual partner. He scooped his hair back, sat straighter. Maggie had leaned into him, drawing forward on the points of

her knees, her fingers raking up Cole's midsection, turning to claws on his chest. His suit jacket was open and her fingers dented his white shirt.

Cole undid his tie, his hands working deliberately, his face turned up to the chandelier above them, making expressions of extreme pleasure. When the tie was undone, he whisked it through his collar in one quick swipe. Then held her head a while as she did something special to his cock that Max couldn't see but could tell was driving Cole wild.

When Cole got the resolve, his hands slipped up her bare arms, along to her wrists. He gathered them together on his chest, wound the tie around them and Maggie let him do it, held them posed for him to make it easy. He cinched them up tight, tugging on the dense knot he'd made.

Her cock sucking continued, increasing in intensity, her head working in circles, thrusting him deep in her mouth. The tendons in her neck stood out, the muscles of her back shone in the flickering golden light.

Cole's head leaned far back, his mouth falling open, he smoothed her hair as she continued. He said, "Okay, ah, okay, Margaret, that's a good girl. If you're not careful I'm going to come in your mouth."

She didn't stop, her head still bobbing with enthusiasm, her bound hands gathered on his chest.

He took the sides of her head, eased her up, let her lips plop off the end of him and his cock fell back against his belt buckle. Cole looked in her eyes, said, "You want me to come in your mouth?"

"Yes," she whispered.

"Say it."

"I want you to come in my mouth, Cole."

He smirked, his eyes glinting in the firelight, and his thumbs caressed her cheeks underneath her eyes. "Margaret, Margaret, what are we going to do with such a bad girl?"

She didn't smile, but she made a breathy sigh, turned her head in his grip and averted her eyes.

"Come up here," he said. "Come up and sit on this bench with me."

MAGGIE SAT herself side-by-side with Cole, her knees held together, her hands gripping each other, bound in her lap. She looked straight ahead, demurely, waiting for Cole to tell her what he wanted. Her nipples condensed to hard pointed buds, her lipstick worn off by her action, her lips engorged, puffed, agape. A look of fear crossed her face though she didn't fear Cole. Maybe she feared herself, feared the bad thing they were doing. Good. That put Max on top.

Cole idly stroked his cock, smirking at the side of her head, admiring her. He kissed her shoulder, and she sucked her bottom lip under her teeth, her eyebrows raising up in the middle.

"Now, lay back for me," he said to her.

She did, turning and then settling her back on the padded couch. She kept her legs together, her heels on the floor, her knees pressing against the side of Cole's thigh. Her hands clasped to her sex, her ponytail hung over the edge of the couch and down to the floor. Cole got up, turned and put one knee on the leather bench and looked down on her.

"Show it to me," he said.

The two of them sat in side view to the armoire and Max had clear sight of them. Cole considering how his friend would view the acts he would perform on his fiancée, controlling the stage and making a performance out of their tryst even though Maggie had no idea. A warm surge of guilt came through him—letting himself get talked into this.

It was hot. Hotter than any way he'd ever seen her before because this was real. This was Maggie uninhibited. This was Maggie with another man

for real. Doing it for herself, not for both of them. Seeing her this way stabbed sharp and painful but it was so beautiful, so erotic, that he couldn't look away...would never even consider it; the sight of her like this so compelling he would give up anything to watch this play out. He had a profound love for her. He'd seen her change over the years they were together. Always his innocent Maggie, but now, something else emerging, and it was wild—because it had always been there, lurking behind the façade of her sweetness. Just like how he was discovering his own truth. How he wanted to watch. He had his façade as well.

“You can show it to me, Margaret,” Cole said. “Open your legs for me...”

Maggie let one knee open wide but her hands kept her mound covered. Then as she waited for his reaction, her hands slipped up and slowly revealed that private pink part of her. Slick and shining, lips engorged; perfection. And Cole told her.

Cole examined it, his eyes going up and down, his head tilting, Maggie regarding her friend as he assessed her secret space.

“You told me you wondered if it was nice...Margaret, your little pussy is the prettiest one I've ever seen and I'm not saying that to make you feel good.”

She nodded lightly, her fingers beginning to play through it while he watched.

“I've seen so many, Maggie. So many, and this one...is perfect.” He lowered to her and Max could see her belly tremble as she thought he was going to go down on her but he instead merely kissed her belly just below her navel. Her eyes rolled up wildly even at that contact.

Cole said, “Tell me what you want.”

“I want you,” she whispered.

He lowered over her, his hands on either side, his face over hers. Her legs began to lift, her knees coming up, opening herself to him, to the big thing thrusting up out of his fly.

“Tell me, Margaret, tell me the terrible things you want.”

“I...” she squeaked, stopped.

“Tell me,” he said again, and now he began to kiss her neck.

“Fuck me...” she whispered quietly, “fuck my...fuck my ass from the front, fuh-fuck me...kiss me and...a-and shove your tongue d-down my throat.”

Those awful words were like a cold glove clad in chain-mail, reaching into his chest, closing a ghostly medieval grip on his heart... He swore his heart stopped. His vision blurred and his operating systems were seizing up with too much data, his brain whined from feedback. He fell back in the empty armoire, his mouth fell open. A hatred for her stabbed through him and it scared the shit out of him. This was what he wanted. Every dark desire playing out in precision for him and now he didn't want it. It was too dirty. He wanted her to be this kind of slut, but now he wanted to swipe everything off the table, tip it over and send it all crashing to the floor. Too much. Too much...

His eyes welled with tears but he wouldn't cry. He wasn't sad. Bile rose in his throat and he swallowed it back, lips literally trembling. Out of control like one cold night when he was eleven, and he went ice-fishing with his dad and brothers far out on Lake Leelanau. His hands frozen, his insides numb. He sat on the back of his dad's snowmobile as they droned back to shore in the middle of the night with three fifteen-pound pickerel in an orange igloo cooler bolted on the back of Mike's snow machine. He'd prayed they'd reach shore before he died, so sure he was on the verge of hypothermia yet not sure enough to cause a fuss and earn his father's and brother's chagrin. He just closed his eyes and hoped it would all be okay...

As Cole began to kiss her, that absence of life he'd just felt was replaced with a strange warmth. Slowly, as Cole worked himself closer between Maggie's legs and she raised her knees higher and higher, her rump coming up off the bench and her heels pointing up to the ceiling his love for her began rushing in. New love, something Orphic. That cold abyss being filled with warm love swirling in eddies, gurgling, and bubbling. He saw her in a new light. His feelings for her would be forever changed in one moment—yet, hearing her darkest, dirtiest, most honest truth, he fell in love with her all over again. She was his Maggie, she had darkness, she had dirtiness, just like him. This was a gift to him to see her revealed like this, something a man would never get to see from his wife. No man would want to, not in his right mind. But Max knew deep down he loved this.

COLE'S HANDS gripped the back of Maggie's knees and he eased them up to her shoulders. That dirtiest part of her, from her clitoris to her anus, was point blank exposed to him. He lowered, making it slow and teasing; her face peeked between her knees and her expression was excited desperation.

When he suckled her folds finally, she cried out and thrust her head back. Cole worked her pussy, sucking on her mound, running his tongue from top to bottom, letting long swinging strands of spit stay connected as he pulled away. From the armoire, Max could see her legs shaking. Maggie alternated watching with gasping and tossing her head back. He could see her fingertips tugging at the top of her mound trying to keep the skin tight for her lover's tongue.

Cole drew up then, leaving a long quivering string as he raised to his knees over her, let it draw thin until it dropped to her. Maggie's bound hands stroked between her legs. Cole took the tips of his fingers, pushing down and lining his cock up, then running the underbelly through her slippery folds. Maggie still watched, her mouth exercising silently, O shapes and E shapes, breath huffed through her nose. Her fingertips stroked the top of his cock, his foreskin pulling and peeling. She looked in his eyes and she nodded.

The tips of her fingers guided him lower, the fat glans sliding along her seam, lower, over her perineum, then prodding at her anus. Her head went back again.

Slowly Cole eased his thick cock into her and Maggie sighed and hissed, her face contorted in pleasure and pain, vocalizations came, urging Cole to continue.

When he was deeper she stopped him, her fingers slapping on her mound and crying out, "Oh, oh, easy, oh careful."

He kept his cock at the depth he'd managed and lowered his mouth to hers. She kissed him hungrily. Maggie's pale naked skin was so stark against Cole's dark suit. He had one foot on the floor still, one knee drawn up to her hips. Her knees were at her ears, her high heel shoes up over Cole's shoulders.

Their long, passionate kiss broke, and they held each other's gaze, their faces still close enough to touch. His hips worked now, easing that thing in and out of her. She was nodding, her lower lip trembling.

"That's it, Margaret," he said, "that's it. This how you wanted it?"

She nodded again, her eyes lowered, her chin jutted forward urging him to come and kiss her again.

He did, thrusting himself into her and taking her lips again. She blurted a muffled blast of air around his kiss. Still he pulled in and out of her slowly and deeply. They kissed, tongues working over one another, pausing to look into each other's eyes. They built it up, taking their time, he supposed to let Maggie's body accommodate him. After a long while their pace became a steady slow reaming and Cole was giving her what she'd asked for. He was fucking her ass and his tongue was down her throat.

Maggie was loving it though sometimes her face looked like she was in pain. She glistened with sweat, her fingers buzzed energetically over her own clit and soon she had built herself high again, ready for a huge release. Her mouth pulled from his, head thrust back, fingers grinding her clit at a manic pace, she snarled and hissed *Yes, yes, yes*, over and over and Cole raised up. He watched her face, watched her like a science experiment, witnessing all those private personal things that should just be for Max. Her head tossed from side to side and Cole kept his thrusts steady. Slow and deep. Maggie's legs shook wildly now, her breath came fast and loud, her chanting grew louder and quicker, ceased being words and became low unbroken moaning. She thrashed when she came. Kicking her legs against Cole's shoulders and twisting underneath him. She cried and groaned and as it subsided, she gasped for him to stop.

COLE WITHDREW his cock from her and she sighed. His head dashed between her legs at once, kissing her pussy, licking at her. It got her squirming again. Her hands clamped on her stomach, her knees still high, but now her feet bobbed loosely on her ankles, falling lazily without Cole's shoulders to support them.

Then he rose again, big hand smoothing over her glistening vulva, held in a cup. He watched her face as he did it, his thumb extending downward and stroking her reddened anus. He kept that up, playing with her, running his hand back and forth over her shining pussy and Maggie loved it. Wordlessly twisting with his movements, mouth wide, then biting her lip, her eyes clamped shut. Max thought she would come again but soon Cole

slowed. He took her ankle and pulled a leg down. Maggie's head tilted forward, brow tense with worry.

"Up," he said. "Up for me." He hooked a finger on the band of his tie where it crossed over the gap between her bound wrists and he eased her up to sit. She eyed him intently. His fingers worked the knot of his tie undone and her arms came free. She rubbed at her wrists and they showed red lines from being tied.

He held the point of her jaw, his thumb pressed on her small chin. He said, "Margaret, I want you to go to the bathroom now. Okay?"

She nodded, watery eyes trembling as she listened.

"Hanging in there are two robes. Take the belt from one of them and put it in the sink. I want you to run hot water on it. Get it soaked. Wring it out, then bring it here to me. Do you understand?"

She nodded again.

"Good. Kiss me."

She hunched forward, one hand holding his thigh, and watched his mouth as they came together and kissed. Just a light peck, simple and quick, but the sound of their wetness pressing together, the suction as they came away, drove another spike through him. He groaned as quietly as he could in the armoire.

As Maggie stood, a little knock-kneed and wobbly now in her heels after what she'd just done, Cole ran his hand up the back of her leg, caressed that ticklish spot below her rump and she shivered as she walked away.

Her expression was troubled. At once she was into it and also seemingly here against her own better judgment. But she did the things she feared anyway. Maybe hating herself for it. She stumbled out of his view, heading towards him and away to his left. Now there was only Cole.

His best friend Cole, sitting there in a dark suit looking more menacing than Max could have imagined. Putting on a show for their Maggie. Giving her what she wanted. Doing it, as they agreed, to give Max what he wanted too. Convinced him he wanted this—now, facing it, he wasn't so sure. Their mating came with beauty—Maggie was magnificent—but there was too much subterfuge. Too much concealment. How would Maggie react if his presence was revealed?

Cole leaned forward, elbows on his thighs, hands coming together between his knees, interdigitated. His gaze settled on Max, focused on the

space between the open doors, though Max was sure he couldn't be seen. He was being *philosophically* seen. Their eyes stared at one another, and he noted a sadness on Cole's face. His mouth set in grim resolution but there was a gleaming, watery melancholy there too. They stared at one another a long time and Max thought to say something but the fear of Maggie catching him in the armoire was intense. So his mouth worked dryly, making no audible sound other than a wizened clicking.

Maggie reappeared. Cole's eyes moved up to meet her as she returned. She was stunning in only high heels. Her legs long and thin and he'd never seen her look so adult, so womanly. Her ass cheeks flexed, gave off the tiniest jiggle with her steps. She came before Cole and she presented him with a dampened terry cloth belt in brilliant white.

"That's my girl," he said. "On your knees."

Maggie squat low, put one knee on the carpet then the next, hands still extending her gift. Cole read her face, his hands working in circles, the tie wrapping around the knuckles of one, reversing, winding back around the other. He took the belt from her, said, "Turn for me, on your knees, go around and face the armoire."

She scuttled around, working in a half circle on the points of her knees, her heels slipping on and off, showing glimpses of her reddened soles.

Max's heart began to hammer as he sensed a betrayal. This was where Cole would reveal the pervert in the closet. The disgusting toad who tricked her into trothplight. *This, Maggie? This lowlife is the man you're going to wed? Are you sure? I've shown you better.* His lips trembled again.

Maggie stared at the armoire, eyes unfocused, but pointing directly at the gap in the open door. He felt a strong urge to urinate.

HIS SWEET LITTLE Maggie wanted to cheat. Cole showed Max her words, spoken into his camera. Cole feeding her lines to keep her legally immune, his poor girl, bundled in a bed sheet, repeating the words with bashful charm. It killed him. Seeing her as Cole would have seen her, naked in his room together, alone, up to dirty things, having fun and being cute with one another.

Cole convinced him that a one-night-stand with Maggie wouldn't be cheating. Not really. He'd practically gone to his knees pleading his case and, boy, had he ever painted a desirous picture. One Max couldn't refuse. *It wouldn't be cheating, Max. I love you. She loves you. If I can convince her to sleep with me, I swear it's meaningless. She loves you so much. You saw what she said in the video. We all love each other. Let's give her what she wants. Let's do it for her.*

He'd said, *And I can watch?*

Cole had said, *Yes, you can.*

Now here he was hiding in the armoire, having loitered in this room for hours while Cole went off and courted Maggie, texting him to keep him in the loop, sending a message when they were done eating, saying *We may come up, Max.* Then he'd jumped from the couch and situated himself in the hiding spot he'd made comfortable. He had pillows for his knees, had angled the armoire just so, making sure he had maximum coverage of the bed.

The greatest fear had always been that they would do these things without him, they would have something secret between them and they

would giggle behind his back. Cole convinced him this was with mutual love. A troika of love. They would do it behind his back but he would be included. It was the stuff of dreams. Nightmarish as it might be, this was his most perverse desire, and there was no way to refuse.

Now, with Cole getting down on his knees behind her, the two of them kneeling, Cole angling Maggie's face to look into the armoire he realized his mistake. And he thought he was so smart. Tricked by a jock who was his best friend. Cole was no dummy, obviously, but he wasn't on Max's level.

Max's heart turned to brittle charcoal at the realization of how he'd left himself open. Of course Cole wanted Maggie. Who wouldn't want the most beautiful, sweetest girl on earth? A bubbly, brilliant, and talented woman who was a tiger in the sack. How could he have let himself be exposed like this? So dim, Max.

Maggie would now see him, see his betrayals, his lusts, his lies. He'd hidden in the closet and watched her masturbate. Hidden in the closet and spied her with her figure model. He'd used that illicitly gleaned Intel to manipulate her into having sex with another man solely so he could watch. How sure was he that this was for her benefit as well? Maybe it was all for him. Maybe he was the most selfish man on earth and she better deserved a man like Cole. And his greatest sin? This one right here, right now. Allowing her to be broken. Allowing her vow to him to be broken. And he encouraged it. Cole convinced him it was a small thing, something for her, but seeing her face, held in Cole's hand, pointed at him, he realized what he'd done. He'd helped her break their relationship. He'd done this. He'd put her on this path, pulled the lever, switched the tracks, and the steam engine of their love veered off on to a line he'd laid, fraught with badness. Cole would show her. Cole would reveal the truth about the man she thought she loved.

Cole's hand moved behind her, her shoulders came high. Her hands were being tied behind her back this time. Cole turned, retrieved the dampened belt, and now he looped it around her fine ankles, cinched an elaborate knot around them, he imagined the wet made the knot impossibly tight.

Then he was kneeling behind her again, his hands beginning to caress her tummy, her neck. His kisses traveled her neck and her collar and she moaned and tilted her head for him. Her nipples rose to hard stones,

clenching tightly right before his eyes. One hand smoothed the crease of her hip, dipped between her legs and began to work through her pussy.

His heart pounded in his chest. The moment for the grand revelation was passing. This was building again, but building to something else. His breath came from him in uneasy trembling as he watched.

Cole brought a knee up, one arm bracing her under her pert breasts, the other scooping under her knees. He lifted her. Stood upright, bringing her with him, her back to his chest. She gasped, a tinge of distress whining through it. He kissed and bit at her shoulder as he walked with her to the side of the bed, put her heels on the mattress.

Max gasped and chugged, panting soft agonizing sounds. He was wrong. His friend wasn't going to show him for who he was. He clutched a hand over his own heart, gripped the material of his shirt.

Maggie was helpless in his hold. Her hands tied behind her, sandwiched between their bodies, her ankles bound tightly, her high heels on so she couldn't probably even stand if he was to let her down. She was light and lithe, a play toy to him with his strength. Maggie was in ecstasy. He could see it. See in her face that she was lost but wherever it was, she found herself in her mind's theater she loved it. Her head lolled, her eyes were closed, her mouth wet and pouting, hung open.

Max saw below the curve of her ass that Cole had his cock in his hand, stroking it, moving it between her thighs. He stroked it up and down her pussy then, and Maggie moaned like a cat. When he found her aperture, his fingers guided him in, came away, his hips pushing his thick cock inside her. She gasped and cried. Now he stepped back from the bed and her body weight sunk him deep inside her body.

All the worry, all the disastrous thoughts he'd had in the previous moment were washed away as he witnessed the woman he loved being dominated in the way she wanted with the guy they both loved. Sure she was cheating, but they all cared for one another.

Cole hooked a forearm under her knees, held her by her chest, and he fucked her while he stood. Maggie could do nothing. She struggled and squirmed but she was powerless. Powerless, and she loved it. Beginning to wail and cry and gasp with excitement, her face shut off, her mouth wide and exultant.

Cole fucked her hard like this. Max couldn't imagine it being done. Awestruck at seeing it happen. Cole held her to him and he fucked her

wildly, powerfully. Her bound feet bobbed and wagged, her ponytail danced down one arm. She thrashed her head, made all sorts of yelping and encouragement. Max grew to steel, and he allowed himself to stroke it through his sweatpants. There would be no reclamation sex tonight. She couldn't know he was here.

It went on forever. Cole falling back and bracing himself against the wall, they turned and her heels knocked the lampshade off the lamp next to the bed. Her heel tips scraped the bedside table. Max didn't know how long Maggie could take it. The sex was extreme. Her vocalizations were pronounced. The slick sounds of Cole's club reaming in and out came quicker and quicker. He turned her and put her heels on the wall. She missed, the shoes clattering on the wooden window frame, then clacking loudly against the glass of the window that looked out over the ocean.

With her braced, he held both her hips now and his thrusts machined in and out in triple-time. She wailed. Her heels scraped and squeaked against the glass.

"Come on, Maggie," he grunted, "come on, come for me, come for me..."

She began to chant *Oh, oh, oh*, and each time she got higher and louder. Her face pinched like she'd been punched in the stomach, and she hunched forward, then her head launched back almost striking Cole on the chin when she came. She cried out so loud management would be here knocking on the door in a minute. It went on and on and Cole clamped his hand over her mouth. Air blurted around his fingers. She twisted and shook, pressed her hips forward, her knees coming apart as wide as her binding would allow. Cole's cock slipped almost free and Max saw it shining from her wetness, saw the girth that his girl had taken.

A sprinkle arced up from between her legs, spritzed high up the glass, pattering against it lightly. Cole slapped his other hand between her legs, started shaking and jacking her clitoris, and the stream continued in spurts that danced between her legs.

"That's it, that's it, Margaret, that's my good girl...look at you go..."

MAX TOOK on the immobility and weight of an ancient bronze statue. Breath had stopped, his heartbeat a pale flutter as he was deadened by what he was witnessing. Cole had rendered her useless by fucking her. She whimpered and moaned and her body went heavy and lifeless. Cole turned and lowered her onto her belly on the bed. She writhed bootlessly, her feet still dangling off the edge of the mattress. She'd been fucked into oblivion by his best friend. The hot and damp confine of the armoire seemed suddenly cold and coffin-like. He was sure he liked what he saw but there was a profound sense of place that fell over him. Like he stood on the precipice of Nietzsche's abyss.

Cole's hands went up and down her legs, over her back. He seemed concerned but not overly so. He removed her shoes, bent her knees. When he kissed the soles of her feet Max could see her toes wiggle and flex. Cole smiled as he removed his jacket, tossed it onto the couch at the foot of the bed.

He got up on his knees on the bed next to her, his big hand smoothing the pale, glossy skin of her back. He was looking at her face but from this angle her head was turned from Max so he couldn't see her expression.

The knotted tie was undone. Cole sitting peacefully next to her and undoing her bondage. He pulled her feet up again, bent her knees and worked the tight knot out of the terry belt. When it was off, he tossed it away on the floor. As he kissed the soles of her feet again, cupping them in both his hands, she began to stir, her shoulder blades working as she came up on her elbows. Getting over top of her he kissed up the backs of her knees, slowly up the backs of her thighs. She began to flinch and twist as he came to her ticklish spot below her cheeks. Cole kissed past them, working around her sensitive zone, then coming up the middle, kissing and biting at the crack of her flawless ass. His hands swooped up, his thumbs peeled her open, and he worked his tongue over her anus. Now she was moving.

Her chin pointed to the canopy over the bed, her head rocked on her shoulders. She rolled over for him, spread her legs. Their eyes met briefly, and she looked at Cole with lachrymose longing. He kissed the inside of her thigh and she closed her eyes. Knees winding in and out as he suckled on the folds of her pussy, Maggie's head rocked on the mattress. Cole unbuttoned his shirt while he did, worked his belt out and undid the pants.

Kissing his way back down her thigh, down to her knee, he slipped off the bed again and stood by its side. He watched her, and she watched him.

She pulled a pillow to her, tucked it under her head, a hand covered her bare sex, tendons working as she began to stroke at herself. Cole undid the cufflinks, put them on the side table, took his shirt off, showed Maggie his tan and his muscle. Dropped his pants. He hadn't worn underwear, and his cock was engorged, thick and bobbing, his noticeably large balls swinging with movement as he tugged his socks off.

Maggie chewed her lip and watched him through lowered eyes. He joined her on the bed and she opened her legs for him. They came together, him on top, her arms circling his back, her knees lifting to accommodate him as he eased his cock up inside her again. They made love. It was passionate and drawn out. They kissed. He held her hands out above her head. He fucked her gently and carefully and kissed her neck, her nipples, watched her expression as he did it all. Maggie was quiet and subdued now, making only breathy gasps and encouraging affirmations.

When Cole was ready to come, he told her. Her feet crossed over his rump and she nodded, looked in his eyes. He thrust in and out, steady and strong, getting quicker and quicker, their breaths coming faster. Maggie began to chant *Yes, yes*, again, her brow furrowed, eyes boring into his, a vein rising up on her pristine forehead. Then Cole roared, stabbed her deeply, withdrew, plunged again. Max could see his scrotum wrinkle, balls raising and releasing as he came inside her. Maggie clutched him to her, one hand turning to a claw and raking through his long blonde hair. Max could see her expression over Cole's muscular shoulder, saw her eyes clenched, glistening runnels of tears on both cheeks, her trembling lips curled back from her teeth, down-turned in a grimace. She was crying.

Cole whispered, "Hey, hey," worried, smoothing his hand over her forehead. She covered her face. "Maggie, don't," he said gently.

She was shaking with sobs now. Cole held her tightly, and he watched expectantly at the hands covering her face, waiting to see her.

"Maggie? ..." he urged. "Please..."

She shook her head back and forth, stopped crying, began again. He withdrew his cock, and as it was free she raised her knees, turned her hips and lay on her side, still crying into her hands. Her sounds were restrained, dry and coughing. Cole lay on his side behind her, hand running up and down her upper arm. "Please don't cry," he said.

Game Show

SATURDAY, OCTOBER 7TH

HE KNEW why she was crying and knew he was responsible. As generous as his gift of uninhibited sex with Cole might be billed, he'd done this for himself. She'd cheated, but it was he who had done it—it was him who had ruined the sanctity of their relationship. He watched from the crack in the door as the woman he loved desperately sobbed in emotional pain and he covered his mouth with a hand. Wanting to console her he had to restrain himself. His fingers pinched on the brass buckle that served as the backside of the knob that opened the armoire door. It would be so easy to push the door open and run to her, take her up in his arms and cry with her. Cry and tell her it would be all right.

But it was nowhere as easy as that. That was his version of events. The one where Max Milton was the hero of the story. That wasn't reality. That was three-act Hollywood, and he was some under-educated fledgling screenwriter.

The truth? He would be stepping out like an evil game show host to reveal this was a prank. A Youtube stunt gone wrong. Maggie, you just got Punk'd. He saw himself through her eyes, emerging from the armoire, a witness to the most profoundly terrible thing that wonderful girl had ever done and he saw himself with hatred. With anger. Maggie would feel victimized. Made fun of. What they'd done was wrong.

Cole's face loomed over her shoulder, fraught with concern, he said, "Maggie...Maggie, please don't cry, please don't..."

Through her hands, she said, "How could I do that?"

"It's okay...I swear it's okay..."

Slowly she withdrew her hands, wiped her cheeks dry, lay with her head flat on the bed, staring towards the armoire. She sniffed and blinked.

“Maggie...” Cole put his hand on her upper arm. She lay a hand over his.

She said, “I just wanted this to be fun. I never wanted it to hurt.”

“It hurts?”

“It hurts so much. My heart... My heart, Cole. My heart is hurting so bad right now. I cheated on him. With you...”

“Maggie, it’s things we’ve already done. You still love him...”

“Stop, Cole... Why did I do that? How could I do that?”

“It’s okay.”

“It’s not. It’s really not.”

Cole ran a hand through his hair, his eyes wild and staring. “Are you...are you mad at me?”

She shook her head no. “I hate myself.”

“Why, Maggie? Don’t do that.”

She started to cry again, her face twisting up, and her hands balled to fists and covered herself so Cole couldn’t see her.

“God,” Cole sighed, “please, don’t cry.” He put his arm around her and he watched the side of her head. He kissed her ear. “Maggie, Max and I love you, you hear me? This will be okay. Maggie, I love you.”

Max winced. There was so much to say and he wished he could be the one saying it. Wished Cole could hear his thoughts.

Maggie said, “Don’t say that—”

“It’s true—”

“Cole, stop.”

“Is that so wrong?”

She moaned again, covering her face up. Her body shook with light sobbing but she made no sounds of crying, only sniffing.

“Maggie, please, Maggie...” Cole said with great concern, putting his hand on her arm and peering around, wanting to see her face. “Maggie, I swear it’s okay. You hear me?”

“Oh,” she groaned, “oh my poor Maxy, oh my poor Maxy...”

“Baby, please, don’t...” Cole soothed her. His own eyebrows had peaked in the middle, the sounds of her sadness drawing it out of him now too. He said, “Max knows.”

“No, he doesn’t,” she cried.

“He does, Maggie... I'm sorry... He told me this was okay.”

“What? No, he didn't...”

“He did, Maggie. He knows.”

Max held his breath and watched. This was possibly the worst thing to happen, but if it would stop her from hurting, he wanted it. The sound of his perfect Maggie suffering was killing him. Maybe it would just be better for everybody if she was angry over sad. Maybe he should step out and take his punishment, his shame. But maybe this would be too big a transgression...

Her shoulders opened, her head rolled to face Cole, she said, “What are you saying?”

“I asked him if this was okay and he said he wanted it. Wanted it for you.”

“You're lying.”

“I swear, Maggie. You didn't hurt him by doing this.”

“What?” she gasped, bewildered, rolling away from him, and staring wide-eyed across the room, right at him though she couldn't see him.

“That fucking...what? Why? Why would he do this to me?”

Max's scrotum bunched up hard like it was made of leather, his shrunk penis recoiled, his heart stopped, his scalp pulled tight, his eyes stretching wide.

Now she whipped around to face Cole, alert and worried. “You didn't show him that video...”

Cole didn't answer, but he shook his head vigorously, telling her no, his eyes wild and scared. He and Cole had both made a mistake here. This wasn't fun, this wasn't sexy, the girl they loved was hurting, she'd broken her own heart because of their actions. Neither of them would want to be party to that.

“Shit,” she whispered to herself, turning from Cole to look out the window at the nautical night. “What am I doing? ...” she whispered, “how did I get here?”

“It's okay, Maggie,” Cole said. “It's all okay. There's no harm done, Maggie, Max and I care about you, we love you.”

He tried to put his hands on her to console her but she shrugged him off putting up a hand of her own in between them and waving him away. She lay down again on the bed her face towards the armoire and Max witnessed the wetness of her eyes and the trembling of her lips. She balled up her fists again and put them over her face.

“Cole, I am in so way over my head I can barely breathe...”

“Secret society, Maggie. We will look out for you. We all look out for each other...”

“You’re not the only other man I sleep with.”

Cole flinched like she’d slapped him. “What?”

Maggie didn’t answer but her fists withdrew and Max could see her staring blankly in his direction.

Cole sat up over her. “Maggie? ...”

She blinked.

“Maggie,” he said firmly, his voice rising with anger. His hand gripped her upper arm.

She shrugged, said, “There’s another guy.”

Cole shook his head in disbelief as he considered what she was saying. He clutched a fist over his heart. Now his eyes rose up to the gap in the armoire and Max could see the anger in him. He let her go, his hands clenched in fists and he sat up on the edge of the bed. Maggie didn’t stir.

She said, “I think he loves me too. Max said I should break his heart.”

Cole’s face turned to watch her as she lay still on the bed, his face forlorn.

She said, “This is all too much for me. Way too much. It’s not what I wanted at all.”

Cole went to her, gripped her arms with both hands and pulled her up to sit and face him. “Don’t. Don’t ever sleep with another man. Okay?”

Max couldn’t see her expression, only the side of her face as she stared into Cole’s eyes.

“Maggie, you don’t ever sleep with someone else.”

“Say it again,” she whispered.

He put a finger in her face, his twisted expression of anger and dominance was genuine. “Don’t you fucking dare sleep with anyone else.”

“Why?” she cried.

“Who is he? Do I know him?”

She shook her head. “Am I a slut?”

His face was angry, disgusted. “No. What?”

“Forbid me,” she cried.

“Forbid you?”

“I hate that I’m bad, Cole,” she said, and she eased her cheek onto his chest. He held her.

But she pushed herself back, said, “Let me go,” her voice a coarse injured whisper. “Just let me go, please.”

“No, Maggie, stay with me.”

She pushed him away angrily, got herself off the bed. Now she stood naked, addressing Cole, who sat up, his face earnest and open to her. Her slender back was to Max, and he felt ashamed that his eyes were drawn to her pert and perfect ass in this painful moment. He chewed the inside of his lip, knowing Cole was seeing her front, bare and unabashed.

She spoke in stuttered breath, shivering tension in the muscles of her back, stiffness in her wagging arms as she railed. She said, “My...my father...the video...the...Ken saw the video...saw us three...the wedding, the dress, the...the...what am I doing with my life, Cole? What am I doing? My Max...wants so much...I want it too...but I don’t want...I don’t know what I want...”

“Hey, whoah,” he said, putting his hands up and moving to the edge of the bed, his feet touching the floor. He moved to hold her wrists, and she thrust her arms out of his reach and turned, one hand on her hip, one across her forehead. She was beautiful like this, one hip cocked, long ponytail over her shoulder, covering one breast.

Somehow she knew about Ken. Somehow she figured Ken had seen them. The word video worried him. Had there been evidence?

Cole stood, Max’s eyes drawn to his swinging, naked cock, and he moved behind Maggie but he didn’t touch her. She began to shake again as if crying, she shed no tears, but her mouth twisted up as if she would.

“God, Max...my Max...”

He flinched at the sound of his name being spoken, but she shook her head, sniffed.

“My Maxy, I cheated on him. How could I do that?”

He needed Cole to act for him, needed Cole to be his proxy—to make their girl feel better, to ease her hurting. Because he couldn’t do it. Didn’t need to if Cole would do it for him.

Cole’s hands covered her shoulders, and she wriggled out of his grip and she turned, punched his chest with the heel of her balled up hand. “How could *you* do that?”

“I’m sorry, Maggie, I’m sorry. I knew I could. Knew you wanted—”

“I just...I just... Fuck, I have to get out of here...”

She shook her head, her eyes wild and staring as she walked to the foot of the bed and scooped her dress from the floor. She threw it over her head, thrust her arms through the straps and shimmied her hips until it fell in place. Her mouth was set firm and angry, her brow lowered but her eyes glimmered wet with sadness.

“Please don’t go,” Cole said.

“I have to. We had to bring the Mercedes, remember? I can’t stay here,” she said as she held a hand on the post of the bed to steady herself as she slipped her feet into the high heels.

Max wanted Cole to grab her, hold her, make her stay. *Just stop her!* Put your arms around her and squeeze her tight until she stops hurting. But he didn’t. He gave her space. He stepped around her, following her. She whisked her keys out of his jacket pocket, snatching it up from where it lay on the floor.

When she was ready, headed to leave, grabbing her clutch off the dresser, she stormed past the gap in the armoire, very close, close enough to feel a breeze from her movement—and that’s when she stopped.

It was deathly quiet, and he was sure she could hear his heart beating a frightening staccato, the wooden walls of the hollow armoire reverberating like the shell of a drum.

“Oh no,” she gasped. She was turned to the side, her body angled to trot down the one step to the lower section, headed for the fireplace, the couch, and the door that would take her out of this luxurious suite. Her head was bowed down, her eyes open and focused, though staring at the carpeted floor. Something had occurred to her. Her head whipped around, her eyes blazing through the gap in the door, looking right at him.

A scream ripped through his insides, his brows darted up in worry and panic. His body began to shudder. She was going to see him, she was going to see him for the liar and manipulator he was. She would see his truth and she would hate him.

She stepped to the armoire door. He smelled her perfume. Her hands came to the knobs and in one second she would whip the doors open and she would see him. Hiding in the armoire, a dirty little pervert in semen-stained sweatpants and a comfortable T-shirt, burrowed in the den he’d made, bringing in sheets and pillows like a dirty bird building its nest.

“Oh, no, oh please,” she whispered, her hands still held on the knobs of the armoire’s double doors.

Her head nodded downward and she let the handles go, afraid of what she would find in the armoire—as afraid as Max that he would be found. She stood, back humped, shoulders slumped. Cole stood at the foot of the bed, head turned down as well, both his hands cupped his genitals.

Maggie walked away. A flood of relief rose up in him. Though she left because she knew he was in there. Knew and didn't want to see it with her own eyes. In that moment he should have kicked the doors open and held her, and if she refused him, he should have supplicated himself at her feet. He worshiped her. But he did nothing. The moment happening so fast it was easier to let time take its course, let the moment play out in relative safeness behind the doors of his coffin. Her heels clicked the floor, grew distant. Something in him screamed to go to her but it was safe and warm in here, damn it, and for now, maybe she wanted to believe her Max was not hiding in the closet having arranged for a man to seduce her and fuck her so he could watch. Would she ever believe it had been for her?

"Maggie, wait," Cole said, putting himself into action now. He grabbed his pants off the floor and thrust his feet through the legs, pulled them up, cock bouncing as he went, going without underwear. The door to the room closed. It wasn't slammed, she wasn't angry. He wished she was angry, he'd rather her angry than hurt.

"Shit," Cole hissed, snatching up his shirt and throwing it on.

Max stepped out of the armoire, blinking in the light, he stood waiting to know Cole's reaction to all this. "Cole...?"

"Dude, don't talk to me right now."

"What?"

Cole paused, looked at him, holding his suit jacket in his hands, his shirt buttons misaligned, so one side of the collar sat askew. "You let her have sex with some other fucking guy?"

He nodded, his eyes breaking contact and looking out the window, seeing only the reflection of the interior of the room. No escape.

"Who? Who the fuck?"

He wanted to shrug, say *Never mind*. Avoid this. But part of him wanted it all to be over. To just repair it all, and maybe Cole could help. "Guy from State. Jay Carmichael."

Cole tsked, exhaled, shook his head in disgust. "Jay Carmichael? You're a fucking asshole."

Now Max watched his friend's reflection. Saw Cole staring at him, felt the disgust, knew it was deserved.

"Just go," he told Cole. "Go to her. Make her okay. Don't let her hurt."

Cole shook his head, "God, Max..."

"Please, go, Cole."

"I am," he said firmly, trying to get Max to look him in the eye.

Max avoided him, still stared at the backward image of the room he saw in the glass. Watched Cole shake his head again, throw his hands up. He slipped his feet into his shoes and ran after Maggie.

When he was alone in the room, he listened to the quiet, to the absence of Maggie and Cole's sounds. The fire still hissed and popped, his heart pulsed blood along the sides of his neck, rushing past his eardrums. He stood for a long while and thought. Thought about all his mistakes and what on earth would make it all right. What would make his Maggie happy again?

He went to the bed—the bed Cole and she had fucked on, made love on—and he lay on the sheets. When he found the warm spot where his two best friends had coupled he took his shirt off. He put his bare skin on the heat they had generated and the sheets had soaked from their mating bodies. He nestled into it and wondered what tomorrow would bring. Where would they all be? He'd made some mistakes but he wouldn't be selfish anymore. His hand found a wet spot, and he didn't avoid it. Instead, he clutched the slippery fabric up in his fist and pulled it close to his heart.

Burgeon

SATURDAY, OCTOBER 7TH

SHE WAS WAITING for the valet to return with her father's car when she heard Cole call her name. Right now, though she cared for him, she wanted to be alone. There was nowhere to go. She hugged her own arms and dipped her head. When Cole caught up to her, coming down the steps from the double doors, dress shoes darting quickly on the carpet, he put his hands on her and held her. It was nice to be in his arms, and while she was mad at him and hurting in a way she couldn't shape in her mind, she was glad for the comfort. She let her back sink into him and he took advantage, sank his arms around her tighter.

"Maggie, if I knew you would be hurt I never would have done this. I only wanted you to be happy. Please don't be mad at me."

She whispered, "Was he in that armoire?"

"Tell me you're okay. I'll do whatever to make you not hurt."

"Was Max in the armoire?"

"We love you. Max loves you so much..."

"He was. Tell me if he was, Cole."

"He wanted to watch."

Her breath chugged from her, stuttering, stertorous, she wanted to cry but no tears came. She looked up to the sky. They stood under the canopy extending out front of the hotel, over the drive; the outdoor fresh, cold, a chandelier glowed above them in amber. The sky was a tragic amaranthine, dim and starless, a perfect reflection of how she felt right now. Empty, betrayed, made fun of, taken advantage of...and while her tormentors were

two men she loved, the pain was still deep. Their love for her may have dulled the blade, but it wasn't enough to stop the damage.

"I'm just a toy," she cried and as soon as she said it, she recoiled at her melodrama. But it was true, she felt like flotsam on someone else's water. She wasn't in charge of her love, or her sex. Her men were. She could act like she was, fantasize and make believe, but truthfully, she was subject to the whims of her men. Their strategies, their fantasies. "Why did you think I wanted to cheat?"

"I don't know..."

"I didn't want to. I didn't want to cheat on my Max. You just want me... You want to ruin me."

"Ruin you? Maggie, I would never—"

They lit up in electric halogen as her father's Mercedes turned the loop out front of the mansion. They both stood upright, their conversation ended. The car roared to a stop in front of them and the red-vested valet trotted from the car and handed Cole the keys, though it was Maggie who had issued them. Another valet held the door of the SL for her and here she was once again at the whim of men.

"I'll drive you home," Cole said, and he guided her to the passenger seat.

There was no alternative she saw but to sit, so she did, scooped her skirt under her legs and put her heels in the foot well of the car, let Cole close her in. He came around into the driver's side and started the car again.

They stayed silent from The Poirot all the way past Newport. On the Newport Bridge she turned to regard him. His face was stony serious. All the charm and warmth she'd seen from his handsome face on the drive here from her home, all the promise, all the hope she'd secretly kept had been dashed. Now she saw her friend again. Max's friend. Her friend. Her good buddy, Cole. A man she'd known for years now and had enjoyed as a friend but had never harbored feelings for though she recognized his gifts. Now she'd been with him. In a threesome with her husband-to-be... Anal sex—playful, submissive sex that she'd fooled herself into thinking was simple college hi-jinx. Tonight he'd seduced her, and while neither of them would fully admit it, he'd won a piece of her heart. He'd shown her the sex she'd craved. He'd given her the things that she hadn't even admitted to herself that she wanted. He'd shown her what he could do. And part of her had always known he was the man to do it. She'd never thought she deserved

him. She never thought she was good enough. This Cole sitting next to her had proved she was good enough, had proved that she was worth winning. The sex they'd had tonight was on a different level than she'd ever had in her entire life. Different than with her loving Max, different than her indecent stud Jay. This sex with Cole was what she craved. God, what any woman would crave. Dinner with a handsome, funny man, seduction, intrigue, drama, tying her up and fucking her holes, making her go out of her mind with his dominance, making her come so many times she truly—sitting here right now only half an hour later—couldn't remember. She remembered tinkling. Remembered a pleasure so enormous washing over her that the only escape she had from it, before it drove her mad, was to let it go. She'd let her muscles relax or she would have fucking screamed from overwhelming rapture. Then while he continued to rail in and out of her, delivering incredible pleasure with each thrust, something wet had sprinkled from her. Urine or who knows what, it sent a tickle through her that put her lights out. She'd lost consciousness. She was sure of it. Then when she didn't think she could take any more, he'd disrobed and made love to her.

Max had watched it all.

And being viewed, that simple act of her husband-to-be witnessing those actions, had turned that pleasure 180 degrees into completely shameful sin. The aftermath of that sex with Cole had left her awash in enormous guilt. And now since she was sure Max had watched, had orchestrated the whole evening, all that passion she'd felt with Cole was seen in a carnival mirror. Distorted, ugly, manipulated, shocking. *Untrue*. Her heart felt crushed. She'd soared to where she'd never gone, now she was realizing it was all a dream. It was all her wicked Max's sex fantasy. He'd given her a gift, and all its allure was only rented. Not hers forever, but hers for an evening. Something in Cole's eyes had told her it was real, and now faced with reality, she didn't know how much of it was part of the play. She was afraid to ask.

There was much she wanted to say, but she was frightened. So she turned her eyes back to the road, watched the fairy lights of Jamestown sail past, the muffled power of the Mercedes evident, her Cole working her father's car with some precision, getting them onto the gravel hills that led to the southern point of Conanicut. He stopped at the gate to the house, unsure of how to open it. She'd fallen into reverie, an elbow on the sill of

the door, her cheek in her palm. She reached across the console and fingered the car's control screen. The gates to her home opened wide for them and Cole drove through.

WALKING the driveway together he took her arm. She let him. She was still unsure in her heels and the deflating events of the evening had left her unwilling to strut for him. All that little girl sass she'd left the house with extinguished. If it weren't gravel, she would have kicked the shoes off and continued barefoot.

"You don't hate me do you?" he said.

"Hate? No."

"Are you mad at me?"

"I don't even know, Cole."

At the door she punched the security code and walked through the kitchen. Cole followed, and she didn't stop him. They passed through the hall, under the eyes of father's cameras though she was sure she didn't care any more. Up the stairs and to her room, Cole was still behind her, silent and slow, keeping his distance.

In her bedroom she kicked the heels off finally and went into her closet alone. Cole lingered by the bed, his hands in the pockets of his trousers. She shrugged off the dress, found comfortable clothes. The normal Maggie things; a comfortable, expensive sweatshirt with a wide neck and some leggings. No panties because those were in a drawer in her dresser and Cole was out there. She slipped low socks on, then a pair of pure white K-Swiss.

She grabbed her travel bag, went into her room, threw it on the bed and rifled things into it.

"So what are we doing?" she asked him without looking up.

"What do you mean?" he said.

"Well, what fucking is supposed to happen now?" she said, rifling her iPad into the bag.

Cole came around the bed and he held her wrists.

"Don't, Cole," she said, but she didn't struggle.

"Maggie, what's going on? What do you mean what's happening now? ...Why are you so mad?"

“Are you kidding me?”

“Maggie, don’t... We didn’t want to hurt you.”

“You did.”

“I’m sorry. I know he’s sorry too.”

“Take me home.”

“Home to—”

“Take me to Farmingham. I want to go home.”

“Maggie, I’m not leaving Max here.”

He stood before her in the quiet room, the sound of his suit jacket brushing against his shirt as he breathed. Both her hands came up to cover her face.

“Max was watching,” she said.

Cole put his arms around her, and he held her and there was that feeling again. As reluctant as she was to acknowledge it, Cole made her feel safe when she was in his arms.

“I’m ashamed of myself,” she whispered through the gap between her hands.

“Ashamed? Why?”

“Ashamed of the sex we had.”

“How could you be ashamed of that?”

“The things we did. I did them with you. It was private...but Max watched. They were for me and you.”

“I’m so sorry, Maggie.”

“The things you did to me...”

“Yeah?”

“I’ve never had sex like that.”

He was nodding above her, then his chin coming down to rest on the crown of her head.

She softly whispered, “My body has never reacted like that.”

“It was incredible.”

“Cole...it was so incredible.”

Cole breathed against her, and she pressed tighter to him. His breaths came quicker. He said, “He’s not here now...”

Putting her palms flat on his chest, she looked up in his eyes, saw him looking down at her. She made to speak, stopped, sucked her lower lip under her teeth. After a moment, she said, “No, he’s not...”

Maybe her chin moved first, maybe his dipped low first, but her eyes were on his lips and she watched them slowly come toward her. She pressed hers to his, felt them warm and soft, plump, her heart pounded in her chest. His strong hands swept her back, up and down, settling finally, both of them, laced over the small of her back. Her hands went up the sides of his neck, her fingers working around his ears, her thumbs tracing the hard stubbled line of his jaw.

Then they were falling back on the bed, him on top of her. A tear was squeezed from an eye and it rolled back into her hairline above her ear. She peeled her own shoes off with her toes, let her knees fall wide, let Cole put his weight over her body. His hand traveled under her sweatshirt, slipped under the tight waist of her yoga pants and she thrust her hips to meet his fingers. He worked her sex with her rapidly rising excitement. Their kisses grew with lust, their breaths heaving. A finger slipped inside her. Then two, and she squeezed them as hard as she could with the muscles of her belly. Her sex gushed around his intrusion, she felt the tickle of rolling rivulets between her ass cheeks. She ached for his cock. She felt it against her thigh. Hard and ready, the wide cable underneath it grinding into her soft flesh.

She kissed his neck, and he lifted his chin to let her. Her hands worked the buttons of his shirt, opening them all the way down, and then she kissed his skin, took a nipple in her mouth, sucked on its tight masculine shape. He groaned, and the rumble in his chest excited her, made her hips buck against the fingers he plunged in and out of her. Nails scratched his bare skin, slipping underneath the open shirt, tracing around his back, feeling the heat of his skin, feeling the beautiful movement of his muscles.

Then he was over top of her, his hard cock pressing into her pussy, his hand roaming up her body, under her sweatshirt, warm against her eager skin. His mouth went over hers but she gasped into his kiss for him to stop.

“Wait,” she said, “wait, wait, wait...”

“What?”

“No, stop, Cole,” she said, even while speaking the words her hips were grinding against his hardness, and she could feel the width of his cock pressing her excited labia apart through the thin material of her pants.

“Stop?” he said, breathy and disappointed.

“Stop,” she said, “please.”

He groaned again, this time it was defeated and tinged with disappointment and he lay his head on her chest. “Fuuuck,” he sighed, his

hips still working his erection into her.

"I know, I know...Right? ..."

"You're right," he sighed. Now he lay his forehead against her chest, and she let her hands smooth the hot skin of his back, enjoying it, but still attempting to de-escalate their passion.

He rolled off her, lay side by side with her, both of them looking up at the incredibly high ceiling of her concrete bedroom. He lay a forearm across his forehead and his breathing still came with excited urgency. "What's happening...what is happening with us...?"

"I don't know, Cole," she gasped.

She sat up, straightened her sweatshirt, pulled it down to cover her tummy. She stared at her shoes laying on the floor next to her bed, one sole side down, the other laying on its side. Pulled off in a moment of intense passion. Evidence of what was transpiring between her and her best friend. It was so obvious though, wasn't it? So natural. The attraction between them wasn't something surprising. At one time it had been forbidden and duty and protocol had kept them on their best behavior. Only now her Max had stripped away all sense of decency and procedure...

That wasn't true at all, really. Just one way to look at it. In fact she had acknowledged nothing she may have ever felt for her Max's best friend (and later her best friend), because she thought he was out of her league. She was just happy to be his friend so that others could see her associated with him. And while there had never been a moment that transpired between them in the years they knew each other, the moment Max had loosened her leash, she'd gone for Cole. Unzipped him, put her mouth on him while Max watched. That wasn't for Max and none of this was Max's fault.

Her feet slipped back into the sneakers, and she hunched forward, sighed heavily and Cole sat up next to her. He rubbed her back and then hugged her to his side, kissed the top of her head.

"I have to get out of here," she whispered.

He helped her gather up her things, and they went back downstairs. In the kitchen she found a fresh sheet of paper and she used a pen to leave her parents a note. She thanked them for the hospitality and she thanked her mother for taking the time with her today to help her select a wedding dress. Told them she would call them tomorrow, that Cole was passing through the area and that they'd gone to dinner and she might as well get a ride back to Vermont tonight rather than shuttle her way back tomorrow. She thanked

her father for the talk they had today. She signed it, slapped the pen down and shut the lights, left without looking back.

They climbed up into Cole's Jeep and went out the gate and down the gravelly road, the headlights bouncing along the towering trees that lined the way.

As they passed through Jamestown, she turned to Cole and regarded him again. Watched his handsome face as he eyed the road, lit from the gauges. His hand worked the gearshift. When he finally looked over at her, she smiled. He smiled back.

She told him she would go to Harvard for law next year. The happiness didn't leave his face, but it washed with a darkness, his eyes narrowing, his jaw muscles flexing. He held his open hand out, palm up, and she put her fingers through his and squeezed.

Midnight

SUNDAY, OCTOBER 8TH

HE WOKE from sleep with the sound of the heavy door of the suite closing. He snapped upright, a sharp intake of breath scoring through his nose. Maggie and Cole stood at the door. Maggie in front, Cole behind her, one hand on her waist.

The fire had dwindled, and they glowed in a dark orange. He stared at them a long moment and they stood blankly, watching him. He looked away, over to the side of the bed, the clock turned over to midnight.

Out of bed, he crossed to the steps that led to the lower level. Paused there. Maggie bit her lip, her eyes watching him, blinking. She wore a sweatshirt now, leggings and sneakers. She tossed her purse onto the couch and stepped toward him. With fearful hesitation, he put a foot down, came to her level, stepped toward her. Now they were both moving, walking with restraint and stiffness towards each other. Her brow furrowed, her eyes gleamed with wet, and her mouth curled in a wriggling bow as they came together and his arms circled her. His heart exploded in his chest at the feel of her against him. Thin arms went around his back and she hugged him weakly.

“Oh, Maggie,” he whispered in her ear, “Maggie, I’m so sorry, I don’t know what I’m doing anymore...”

“Why did you do that to me, Max?”

“I don’t even know...I thought...you wanted that...”

“Maxy, I cheated on you. I really cheated on you.”

Now he felt the sting of betrayal. As if it hadn’t been clear to him before, like it was a blurry picture and he thought he could make it out, could see

the shapes that warbled in the image. But now, hearing her words, it was razor sharp. She knew she had cheated. And if she knew it, then it was. It was true. She had cheated on him. Didn't know this was a game at all. Her infidelity was real. Cole had sold him on it being acceptable because it was safe and they all loved each other. But it was profoundly wrong. And they were both party. A hard lump formed in his belly, and his breath came with struggle. But instead of recoiling, instead of suffering, he hugged her harder. The more he squeezed her the greater the joy he felt. He loved her completely, and he would never let her go. If that was also true then this evening was nothing. All that was left was her hurt but he could soothe that.

"I did it, I made it happen, Maggie. I knew you would. I knew it was okay..."

"How can it be okay, Maxy?"

"Because I love you so much."

"I love you too, Max," she whispered, and her hand clawed the back of his neck. They kissed. It was stiff, awkward, but he welcomed her cool, wet lips.

COLE SAID, "You two are okay, right?"

Max turned to see him, arms folded, leaning his butt on the back of the couch, the dim fire glowing behind him.

Maggie said, "We're fine."

"We are. We're fine, right?" Max said to her, turned back to look in her eyes.

"You tell me," she said, her mouth poised neutrally, afraid to smile.

"You tell me," he said. Also not smiling. Also not sure. What happened was a big mistake and everything in him wanted to pick her up and be the way they were before she left but there was some sort of unseen barrier between them. Nothing was stopping them from embracing and forgetting, but a film had slipped in between them, coated them, made each other too slippery to hold. He'd wanted to watch her cheat. He'd been rewarded. But that meant she had cheated. She was mad at herself for cheating, unsure what it meant that he wasn't mad she'd cheated, and then also struggling with the anger that her two best friends had orchestrated the whole thing.

He imagined that, given she had not one other person in the world to turn to, she was stuck accepting what they'd done to her for the moment. He hoped deep down, she felt the way he did, she wanted to move past this and return to their feelings before she left Farmingham.

"I'm fine," she said quietly.

"I'm fine too," he said. Their bodies had come away, and he wanted so much to pull her back, squeeze her tightly again, but part of him worried she would reject him, part of him worried that she didn't want that right now. He let them part farther, but he took both her hands in his. She had trouble meeting his eyes.

"Well, what the fuck," Cole said. "I guess...I guess we're staying here tonight." He crossed from the couch, passed them, stepped up to the raised end of the room, onto the quiet carpet.

Max said, "Is that okay, Maggie? You okay to stay here?"

"What else are we going to do? It's midnight..."

Over his shoulder, Cole said, "I'm way too tired to drive. I'm crashing." He shrugged the suit jacket off and threw it on to the couch at the foot of the bed. The place where all those wonderfully bad things had transpired. He put his hands on his hips and regarded both of them. Max noticed his shirt had been re-buttoned so it was aligned properly, and he had a sudden punch in his stomach, wondering what transpired while they were away. Maggie changed clothes. They'd gone to her house. Were her parents home? What if they fucked again behind his back?

He squeezed her fingers between his and looked in her eyes again. "Maggie, I love you so much."

She cocked her head, winced. "I know, Max. I love you too."

He ventured, "Maggie, I didn't want to hurt you...we wanted you—"

"I don't want to talk about it, Max."

"Okay," he said, everything in him wanting to gush his feelings to her. He'd drop to his knees and plead if Cole wasn't here watching.

"It's fine, Max," she said again before slipping her fingers away from his. She turned and stepped up to the raised end, walked to the side of the bed.

Cole still stood, hands on hips and she walked right past him, Cole's head swiveling to follow her. He looked back to Max and shrugged, chewed his lip.

At the side of the bed, she loosened her ponytail, took the tie out and shook her hair free. Unclasped her jewelry and placed it on the bedside table, then pulled her shoes off with her toes. Turning her back to them, she pulled her shirt up over her head and tossed it to a padded chair sitting against the wall. She covered her breasts with a forearm and slipped under the sheets. Her knees came up as she dug her heels into the bed, working under the covers to take her yoga pants off. A bare arm came out and flung them to the chair. She tossed, turned, lay on her side.

Cole's eyes held Max's, and he couldn't tell what his friend was feeling. Were they both mad at him? This was Cole's idea. But then again there had been the big revelation about Jay Carmichael. He supposed Maggie spilled her guts to Cole while they were away together. What could she have said? Were the two of them working against him now?

Cole moved to the opposite side of the bed, undid his shirt, pulled off his pants and socks. Got into bed next to her completely naked. They didn't touch, didn't acknowledge each other. Cole lay on his back, looking at the canopy of the bed, Maggie lay facing him, her eyes closed.

"Yeah," Max sighed, joined them, coming to bed on the same side as Maggie, slipping his sweats off, getting naked and slipping in behind the woman he loved. He lay a hand on her waist and she didn't shoo him away. No one made a move, all of them laying there quietly breathing. Eventually Cole leaned to the side and switched off the light. Soon they were all asleep.

AT THREE IN the morning Max woke with the stroking of Maggie's soft, perfect foot along his shin. Opened his eyes, saw her dim face obscured in shadow, her cheek and the edge of her nostril lit in nighttime blue. A glint of light reflected from her open eye.

"I can't sleep, Max," she said.

His heart pounded wide awake in two heartbeats. Every bit of him wanted to lurch over her, take her, shove his tongue in her mouth, force his cock between her legs, make her come, make her whole, make her his again. But he played it cool while his pulse flitted excitedly up his neck.

"Me neither," he said.

She darted her lips to kiss his quickly, pulled away to watch him. Her back was toward the windows and his face was lit better than hers.

“Maggie, I—”

Maggie pressed his lips closed with the tip of a finger and he sighed. A knee came up, bumped his knee, slid up the outside of his thigh. The fabric of the bed sheet bulged as her hands searched underneath, found his wrist, led his hand low. He didn't need instructions. Once she had his hand, had opened her legs, she was giving permission, and he was just glad to be part of her world again. He stroked her tight tum-tum, chuckled breathily, his fingertips sliding lower, exploring the soft plump shape of her vulva. His conquering middle finger stroked first, over her folded hood, parting her labia. He gasped. She needed no warming up.

His finger made wet sounds heard even under the bedding. She watched him still. A bit too timid to venture dirty talk right now, he concentrated on serving her. Stroked and dabbed at her opening, parting the petals of her flower, he teased her. Her lips parted and her eyes narrowed. She grunted softly and her hips churned, her delicate hand stroking his forearm. When he kissed her lips she kissed back, but she wasn't her passionate self, she didn't consume him. They would have to work to get back to where they were. He might have damaged the relationship, but the boat wasn't sinking. It could be patched.

She gasped away from his kiss, not rejecting his lips but seeking air as her breathing became quick and heavy. The heel of her foot she had draped over him dug into his calf, urging him closer. His cock had turned to a hard, iron column in mere seconds after she'd woken him, so hard it throbbed. He worked his fingers through her oily flesh, her sex so productive he smelled her every time their movements rustled the comforter, moving her excited scent past his nostrils, driving him crazy. His fingers thrummed her, made wet smacking noises and now she squeaked with excitement, baring her teeth to him. He slowed, resumed spreading and stroking her.

She cupped her hand under her mouth and she spat a long stream of saliva into her palm and he resisted the urge to tell her his excitement. It would be obvious. He let her lead the way, show him what she wanted. The hand disappeared under the covers and he held his breath, thrust his cock out for her to find. The edge of her hand bumped around, found his hardness, gripped him and stroked her abundant spit up and down his shaft.

“Oh fuck, Maggie,” he sighed.

When she had him coated with the lubrication, she rolled to her other side, showed him her back. Facing Cole now she pressed her rump towards him, parted her legs, reached between them, found his erection. He shimmied down the bed helping guide himself between her legs. He got his own hand in there, stroked her sex while she angled her pelvis towards the point of his incredibly hard penis.

When he pushed she moved away, dipped lower. Did it again, and she shied away. Her hand still guided him, the tips of her fingers angling him.

“What?” he whispered. His eyes roamed over the shape of her head and her wild, silky hair spread on the pillow, to see Cole still sleeping. His handsome profile a black shape against the dusky blue of the bedding.

“Don't move around,” she whispered back to him.

Then she wriggled against him, guided his glans along her sex, getting it nice and slippery—but now she pushed him farther back.

“Okay,” he whispered.

Maggie guided him to her anus, and he braced the curve of her rump with an outstretched hand. She pressed back to him and he wiggled his own hips now, letting her saliva coat the ring of her sphincter so he could slip inside that very tight space. She grunted, gasped, made a squeak, and her sexy noises drove him wild.

Her hand came away, gripped a wad of sheets as he sunk deeply inside her. He flexed his cock, felt it bulge against the incredibly snug restraint of her anus, inducing a ticklish spew of his own lubricant inside her. His strokes came easy now. He fucked her ass slowly and gently, the light playing along the angles of the silky smooth skin of her shoulders arms, and back. Watched her squinting profile as her body accepted him back there.

Watched then as her hand moved beneath the sheets, stretching, reaching across to their friend. A tenting in the fabric appeared as Maggie stroked Cole's stomach to wake him. His eyes fluttered, opened, looked up to the canopy, then his head jerked around to face her. The corner of his cheek pulled up high and Max figured he must be smiling. She whispered something into his ear as he turned to his side to face her, and his hand gripped her arm just above her elbow.

They kissed, their mouths making wet sounds against each other, their heads slowly rocking. Max reached out, held the top hem of their bedding and unfurled it down their bodies, exposing all three of them. He wanted Cole to recognize that Maggie was engaged with him physically, that they

were making love. He made big, sweeping movements with his hand, up and down her haunch, up to her waist and caressing her baseball-sized breast, plucking at its swollen bud, then back down. Cole saw, and his hand cupped her neck while they made out.

Their kissing had passion. It had changed from their first time together and it made him wonder what she had done with Cole the night she was vague with details but admitted she'd jerked him off onto her stomach. The night he also learned they'd discussed cheating together. Discussed leaving him out. His worst nightmare. And yet, they'd done it in a way that showed him it would be pretend. That Maggie truly loved him, wouldn't cheat on him, and Cole had wanted to facilitate something he thought lurked in Maggie. He'd been fucking right too. She sure wanted it. And boy did she sure get it. He'd thought about what he'd witnessed tonight a lot before he'd fallen asleep on this very bed in the warm spot his two best friends had made.

Mostly it was the personal things she'd shared with Cole that had never been shared with him; the spanking, the orgasms, the bondage, the squirting. Those were between her and Cole and they were only meant for Cole. Those were things that were done behind Max's back when she thought he wasn't looking. All this time he thought he was getting to know the real Maggie—that he gave her the gift to be who she really was, that he was doing things, giving her things, no other man ever could, but he was wrong. She kept this from him. There was a secret part of her that was unknown to Max, but she'd shown it to Cole. She'd given it all to Cole.

Soon his cock had crumpled, and while he thrust, her tight aperture resisted him, buckled his semi-hard cock, folded it up as he tried to fuck her.

Maggie broke from Cole's lips and whispered over her shoulder, "What's happening?" She wiggled her bum against him for emphasis.

"Nothing," he whispered.

She moved away. Probably didn't mean a thing by it, just wanting to have a good time, but when he failed to please her and she literally went to the arms of another man, it was a symbolic punch in his heart.

Her body shimmied along the sheets, got herself closer to Cole who then put an arm right around her, an object in between her and Max.

He lay a hand on her back while she ran her hands through Cole's hair and they still rocked their faces together.

He wasn't out. He could sit and witness but Maggie belonged to him, and he was a part of this, so he shimmied closer just as she did, getting right up behind her, his cock poking into her ass cheek, still not hard enough to penetrate her, but not a saggy nothing. His hand swept her hip, curled around her tummy and eased low between her legs.

Cole's hardness ran along the back of his hand, alarming him; he withdrew quickly. But that was exciting—Cole's erection was brought on by their Maggie and they were all friends and they were about to have a real good time. Her hand squeezed the muscles of Cole's shoulder, her nails denting his flesh as she got a good feel of him. His hand lay over hers and he laced his fingers through hers, piggy-backing over top. He took control of her hand, ran it under Cole's arm, down his waist. Maggie's breathing increased and Max's erection returned with renewed zeal. Their hands flipped underhanded and Cole lifted his leg to open himself up to them. They moved down his belly, his hard cock sticking out straight and upward. He lay their hands on it, gripping it. It was massive. His hand was over Maggie's so it wasn't an accurate gauge, but he could tell how much girth his friend had. He stroked Maggie's hand up and down him and she complied. She moaned, and her body shook with excitement against him. Their kiss broke and Maggie gasped, "Oh fuck," to the room, her breath coming rapidly as she and Max stroked her lover.

"Oh fuck," she whispered again, "oh God," her chest rose and fell in heaving lurches. Cole took one of her nipples in his mouth and he suckled at her. They still stroked him, up and down him from glans to base. Then Maggie slipped her hand from under Max's and she grabbed him by the thumb, shoved his hand lower and he let her. Her hand lay over his and she used his hand to grip Cole's balls.

"Oh shit," he whispered into her ear, his cock harder than it had ever been. He wiggled his hips, pushing his cock towards her anus again.

Cole's balls filled his hand and he was careful with them. Had no idea how to handle balls. Knew his own could be hurt easily, so he was cautious. They were hot and sticky, huge, maybe twice the size of his own balls. They were foreign in his hand, the only ones he knew were his own. Maggie stroked him quicker, her breaths still rising and falling with lustful intent, breath scoring through her nostrils loudly. Cole's hips worked now, thrusting his cock through her grip, and she gasped *Yes, yes, yes* with each one. Max let Cole's scrotum down carefully, his hand came behind Maggie

and he took his cock in his grip, marveled at the hardness that had returned, stroked his tip along Maggie's wets seams, found her opening and she paused her movement, eager to have him. He plunged his slippery cock into her backside and she cried out over top of Cole's head.

Three

SUNDAY, OCTOBER 8TH

MAX EASED his painfully hard erection in and out of her while she kissed Cole, her hand running up and down his cock. He gripped her waist, watched the tip of Cole's cock, saw his Maggie hand on it, saw the foreskin open and close. Moonlight glinted on silvery wetness streaming from him. He closed his eyes, his heart pounding with excitement. Cole was producing semen to lubricate the passage of his cock through Maggie's vagina. It was so taboo, so wrong, so awful. Why the fuck was it so exciting? There was so much dirtiness to it yet it was tinged with friendship and love. He cared about Cole, loved him he had to admit, and he loved Maggie. A jealous sizzle ran through him, right up his center from his anus, zipping through his organs, electrifying his heart, making a ground connection somewhere along the inside of his skull. The passion was intense. They were both going to make love to their best friend, Maggie Becker. They were going to make her come over and over. His ears filled with the wet sticky sound of his cock parting her anus, the sound of her hand using the foreskin to jerk Cole's cock off, the wet sounds of their lips smacking together. He streamed more precum inside her and now his passage was like slippery velvet. Maggie moaned.

Cole worked himself higher up the sheets, put an elbow into the center of his pillow, his shoulder against the headboard, guided Maggie's mouth to his cock. Her hand went to those large hanging balls, gripped them, his brown sack as big as a tennis ball in her graceful grip. Her sweet mouth went over the end of his cock, her lips purposely tight, forming a grip on his

foreskin so she could expose his shining glans to the inside of her mouth. Max watched her neck muscles work as she bobbed on their friend's cock.

Cole softly moaned, watching her head go up and down, his hands gathering her hair, exposing her beautiful face so they could watch her. He caressed her head, scratched at her scalp. Doing it with care and love, and she moaned around his size, her head rocking. Her lips came off, and she kissed down the side of his shaft, kissed his hip, her hand coming up from his balls to stroke and swirl on him.

Sounds were coming from her throat, sweet little gasps, unuttered, gentle happy squeaks caught inside her, she tried to say something but her lips stuck together.

Cole said, "What? ..."

"To-together," she whispered.

Her nails scratched at Cole's stomach, like she was trying to pull him to her and Cole slipped down the bed so he was face to face with her. Their kissing resumed, her wet, shining hand cupping his cheek, her nails raking his stubble. She parted her legs and Cole's hand covered her raised knee, then slipped down the inside of her thigh, not hesitating, coming down and working over her eager pussy. She was streaming her juices; Max could feel them warm and ticklish against his thigh, seeping into her crack and making his cock even slipperier inside her.

Thrusting in and out of her, doing it for her, not for himself, keeping his strokes even and calm, he massaged her insides with his erection. Cole worked her pussy, dipping fingers into her, stroking and rubbing at her clit. Maggie gyrated with them now, her breaths coming quick but low and whispering. Their kissing had stopped, her face turned in his shoulder. Max could see she was biting at his flesh.

Max took her knee, guided her legs open wider, pulled her so her leg draped right over his hip. Now her sex was widely exposed to them. He still stroked in and out of her, Cole took handfuls of her slippery folds, worked her up and down, dipping low and running fingers around Max's shaft, tickling her anus where he was stretching her membranes. Cole held Max's balls, fondled them, let them go, put a finger inside her, back down and held Max again.

"Oh God," she gasped, then turned on her back, completely opened herself up to them, put an arm around each of their necks. Her eyes were tightly closed and Max knew she was going to come very soon. Cole did

too, and that jealous line tightened again that their Best Man was party to such a joyous personal knowledge of Max's bride. But Cole took her nipple in his mouth and she cried out and Max smiled. This was for her. They loved her and she loved them. So he took the other nipple, and he kept his stroke even and purposeful and Cole slipped two fingers inside her, Max's hand slipped along that tight stomach of hers, his middle finger stretching under Cole's hand to find her button swollen tight and hard. When he touched it she cried out again. They suckled on her nipples, explored their shape, condensed, hard, and alveolate. Her delicate hand gripped his upper arm, his ear in her armpit and they kept her on the edge for a quarter of an hour until they had her whole body shaking. When she finally came she let out a long, thick, wet cry that filled up the room.

MAX PULLED on her limp body, his cock still impaling her behind, rolled with her so she lay completely on top of him, her back to his chest. Her head lolled loosely, her hair tangled in his mouth. Each of his arms snaked up under hers, bending then, forearms curling up next to her breasts and pulling her shoulders far back, thrusting her little breasts up to the bed's canopy. She moaned and cried, her head turning back and forth in the hollow between his neck and shoulder. Cole was up and moving, getting his knees between Max's. His hands went on Maggie's knees now, eased them up, her legs loose and compliant. Pushed them to her chest, exposing her pussy, exposing Max's dirty connection with her anus. Cole kissed her pussy, and she jolted. Her head angled up, she must have seen him between her legs, because she gasped out loud, her head thrusting back to his neck, her tiny ear next to his lips. He kissed her auricle. Cole stroked his hands up and down the backs of her thighs, his tongue working through her labia, his lips pinching up her folds, working her clit.

"Oh God, oh, his...oh, his tongue," she gasped and sighed. Cole's saliva and Maggie's excitement streamed down and it tickled the hair on his balls, joined in with the lubrication he already had for his penetration.

The second time she came wasn't as grand, but it came quite easily because the first one had loosened her. Max watched her ankles cross over one another, bobbing in his vision, so close to him, just over her shoulder.

As the orgasm came, he watched her toes begin to stretch and curl, then as it hit her, they tightened right up and her feet bowed and shook.

“Oh shit, oh God,” he cried now, and it was too late—that intimate view of his fiancé’s feet, their reaction as the Best Man ate her out and made her come with his tongue had set him off. He struggled to pull it back, but it was too late. He was ejaculating before he felt the orgasm. Then he raced to catch up with it. Grunting and thrusting into her deeply, chasing that pleasure. Finding it, a high tickle racing across the skin of his face and scalp as the hot liquid squirted from him. It got Maggie gasping again, sweet affirmative sounds, letting her Max know she felt him coming in her ass and that she liked it.

His hands dropped to her chest while the orgasm still whipped through him and he grabbed handfuls of her B cups and coddled them as his hips thrust slower and slower. Cole’s hand went down, caressed where Max and Maggie were joined, did it lovingly and caring, sweeping up and down.

Maggie rolled off of him, collapsed next to him. She made a pained sound as he slipped out of her backside, and while she lay crumpled on her side, her face in the sheets, her hands came back and soothed her anus. Max could see his semen being squeezed out of her, running over her cheek in a thick white line. He kissed the point of her shoulder.

“I love you,” she whispered. He kissed her again, from her shoulder along her arm to her elbow. “I love both of you so much,” she said into the sheets.



“YOU’RE NOT mad at us anymore?” Cole said, looking up at her through his brow as he kissed the outside of her thigh.

“Still mad,” she sighed, grabbing up a pillow and pulling it under her head, staring off to the side of the room, out the windows. “But I love you.”

Max rubbed her back, digging his thumbs into the muscles of her shoulders.

“I think all three of us are very lucky to have each other,” Cole said, his kiss traveling her hip, making its way to her waist. He was over her on all fours.

She opened her chest up again, her hips turned to the side but her back on the mattress. Her hands reached out, held the sides of Cole's face, her thumbs rubbing under his eyes. "Cole, would you...please, make love to me..."

For a brief second Max noted Cole's eyes dart towards his, but then they were back on Maggie. "Yeah," he said, his voice a husky whisper.

She opened her legs for him and he bowed his back so she could swing her knee out, then when she'd surrendered herself to him, he was between her legs, over her, kissing her. Maggie swept her hands through his hair, the insides of her thighs going up and down Cole's hips. Their heads rocked against one another, their faces hidden behind Cole's blonde hair hanging down.

Maggie stretched her hand out to Max, searching for his, and he took it, cupped his grip over the palm. Cole and Maggie's lips parted, they looked into each other's eyes, breathing heavy. She nodded, her chest rising and falling, her lips working the shape of the word Yes, though she made no sound. Cole's hips lowered, his cock lining up, his hand coming down to guide himself inside her.

She gasped when she was breached, bit her lip and squeezed Max's hand tightly.

"Oh, you feel so good," she whispered, her eyes closed.

"Mm-Mmaggie," Cole groaned, his hips swiveling between her thighs, "God, you feel so fucking tight, so good..."

They worked together, kissing and touching each other, hips grinding in circles, Cole's ass rising and falling. Maggie's legs clamped his hips, her knees came high, for a while their thrusting came with intensity and Maggie locked her feet together. As she became sweaty, her hand slipped in Max's grip, his hold on her getting more and more tentative til she slipped free and that hand went to Cole's back, running her nails over his skin while he fucked her. Their passion brought his erection back, and he stroked himself while he watched.

They writhed together on the sheets for an incredibly long time, their breaths quick and ragged, moaning each other's names. Max sat higher on the bed, reached to the table lamp and switched it on. Now they were lit up and they were even more beautiful in the light. Cole's summer tan, his muscles; he wasn't too bulky, wasn't too big. Just tanned brown and shining with sweat. Maggie's perfect porcelain skin also glowed with excitement.

Her hair tangled on the bed and all her makeup had worn off but she was exquisite. Didn't need makeup. Her face was open and impassioned. Her mouth forming a gentle O shape, her eyes closed from pleasure, her brows tilted up, furrowed. Cole held her hands while his hips worked between her thighs. They were pressed together, just that big fat cock of his stretching her out wide, buried up inside her, and Maggie was loving it, working on him without thrusting, just wriggling and probably squeezing it with her girl muscles.

"I feel you," she whispered while Max stroked his cock. "Cole, I feel you...you're going to come..."

"Yeah," he groaned, "mm, yeah..."

"Come inside me, okay?"

"Yeah, inside..."

"I want to feel you coming in me again."

"I'm going to come," he said, his hips grinding more quickly, his breath coming faster.

"Come inside me, I love the feel of you coming..."

His thrusting came triple time, shaking the bed and making Maggie's cries warble.

"Agh-mm...mm," Cole grunted and roared, thrust deeply as he could and held it as he emptied those large testicles inside Maggie and she wailed in ecstasy. The feel of Cole shooting inside her brought her orgasm and her heels dug deep into Cole's legs, dented the muscles. Her toes curled and her face constricted. Max stopped stroking and watched, his own heart raced wildly and his cock ached to be joining them, to share the pleasure he knew they were enjoying but there was pleasure in watching them. They were incredible together. They were beautiful, and he loved them and if he squeezed his mind's eye to the narrowest aperture, he could block out the sick green jealousy and just focus on the good, the passion they enjoyed.

COLE COLLAPSED ON HER, breathing heavy and laughing. She giggled too, then turned it to a long, satisfied groan as she held him tight, overlapping her arms around his neck. A smile broke her lips wide and Max

was glad to see it. She'd been very hurt this evening and he would do whatever it took to repair her, restore her.

He peeled a hand away from Cole and held it, and he worked his fingers through hers. She rubbed at her sweaty face with her other hand and now she had her natural smile again. He kissed the back of her hand.

He'd gone too far and now he owed her—he was in her debt. The action he took to satisfy his own lust had stepped over a line and now there was a tear in his bond with her.

Cole extended his arms, raised himself off her with a sharp inhale. He looked in her eyes again and they both smiled, then laughed lightly. Cole wiggled his hips, making wet sticky nosies from where they were still joined.

“Oh, fuck,” Maggie sighed, narrowing her eyes. She ran her free hand between them, the one with her diamond ring winking in the lamp light, parted her first two fingers into a wide V and slipped them on either side of Cole's thick cock. He slowly withdrew it, the thing he had shining with wet; deflating, still engorged, but the raging veins laying flatter now. He pulled it right out, both of them hissing quietly, then he dropped it with a sticky smack over her vulva and the back of her hand.

“That was so amazing,” she whispered, slipping her hand out from under it and running her fingertips over the top of him, as he eased it back and forth over her. Semen still leaked from the slit and left an arcing trail on her skin.

Maggie breathed deeply and moaned, turned her head in the pillow and looked to Max. He came close, and she said, “He came inside me, Max...” leaving the tail of the statement high and expectant.

He avoided the intent, said, “Think you can sleep now?”

“Yeah,” she said with a laugh, then, “Kiss me.”

He did, came to her and put his lips on hers, glad to have her make the request, because right now, kissing her was what he wanted the most in this world. They held each other's hand, kissed lovingly and deeply, sparing tongues, but exploring and tugging with their lips. When he pulled back, he could see she was still playing with Cole's cock, running her index finger along the peeling edge of his foreskin, tracing the shape of his coronal ridge underneath.

She repeated, “He came inside me, Max...”

She wanted him to go down on her. He might, but doing that took an excitement that he didn't feel. Right now, while his heart was pounding with lust, it was restricted with hurtful emotion and the worry for the bad things he had done. And he wasn't sure that he wanted Cole to know he did that sort of thing. That thing he did with Maggie was only for them, not for another man to witness.

"Yeah?" he said, disinterestedly.

"Look," she said, and she let her legs slip a little wider.

Cole grunted a laugh, smoothed his hands up and down the insides of her thighs. He knew her insinuation but he didn't know how to respond. He walked on his knees away from her and sat on the edge of the bed with his back to them, watching though over his shoulder.

Max sat up, looked between her legs, saw her perfect slick oyster, pink and wriggled, left open, a thick dash of bright white semen drawing down in a straight line towards her anus. Maggie watched him. He touched her where she leaked. Put his fingertips on her sex and traced the shapes of her vulva, the edges of her labia. Maggie closed her eyes, ran a hand through her hair and nestled her head in the pillow.

Cole sighed, got up, made to say something, didn't. Turned then, walked to the bathroom and closed himself in, leaving them alone.

Max flopped down alongside Maggie, got shoulder to shoulder with her. He watched her profile, wanted to say something, wanted her to say something, but her eyes remained closed. He kissed her shoulder, whispered, "I'm sorry."

"Me too."

"Don't apologize," he said.

She laughed, opened her eyes so she could roll them. Still not looking at him, eyes up to the drapery over the bed, she said, "You wanted me to cheat on you?"

"No..."

"You did."

"I trusted Cole...to make it okay. Wasn't it okay? It wasn't...not against your will or anything—"

"I feel betrayed."

"I'm sorry. I...Cole and I thought it would be exciting for you...to be seduced..."

"I shouldn't be able to be seduced, Max."

“No.”

“You tricked me.”

“You cheated.”

Now she turned to face him and he saw a glimmer there in her eyes, an angle to her brow that showed him she was considering his feelings. She might be mad at him for arranging this but she knew how he might hurt.

She said, “Where does this leave us?”

“I love you more than ever, I—”

“I love you too, Max. That didn’t change. But why am I more mad at you than you are at me?”

“What I did was...really bad.”

“It was, Max.”

He kissed her chin, and she tilted her head away from him. He kissed her neck.

“What can I do to make it better, Maggie? What can I...?”

“I don’t know, Maxy.”

He felt a charge hearing her name him with affection. He kissed the side of her breast, suckled on her nipple, swollen still, and she ran her fingers through his hair and scratched his scalp.

She said, “I don’t know. Tonight...I’m still...it’s all too fresh. Give me some time. We’ll figure it out.”

The bathroom door opened, and they saw Cole’s naked silhouette against the light above the sink. It clicked off, the fan left running, and he walked back to the bed then, a towel in each hand. Max curled next to Maggie, faces side by side and they watched Cole walk, watched the blue nighttime light throw shadows across his body, his shoulders flexing as he went, his tight stomach rippling. His cock was engorged still, almost as big as when he was hard, but without the high heart rate it hung between his legs, bouncing and slapping his thighs as he came to the bed and into the amber lamp light. Max kissed Maggie’s cheek as Cole climbed onto the bed.

Cole sat cross-legged at her feet and he smiled at them both. She rubbed his knee with her bare foot. He took her toes in his hand, lifted her foot and kissed the sole. Her toes scrunched up, and she inhaled briskly, fighting the ticklish feel. The towel was pushed up the inside of her thigh, drying her, moving up to the delta between her long thin legs, rubbing and massaging her. She put hers and over his as he continued to move the towel over her.

Max reached out and snatched the other towel that was brought, dried his genitals, his belly and down his legs. They'd all gotten quite messy.

The towel was eased from her sex, tossed to the floor and Cole kissed the inside of her knee, down her thigh, lightly kissed her pussy, letting his lips linger. Maggie moaned, her legs doing a little dance against the bed. Then he kissed her belly, looked up at her, said, "I think this has been the best night of my life."

She caressed his cheek, whispered "Me too."

It wasn't Max's, he was sure of that. The best night may have been the night they had sex in the alley next to Altieri's. The night she said she might consider sleeping with another man. That was a great night because it was filled with promise but very little of the heartache. That had been exciting. But then, farther back, he thought of the night after he'd proposed to her and she'd said yes. That swamped them all didn't it? Wholesome Max, wholesome Maggie, making love in his dorm room under the enormous promise of what their lives might hold in store for them, a gleaming rock on her ring finger.

Cole took his spot next to Maggie again, laying next to her on the bed, working himself closer. Maggie was agreeable, wriggling herself closer to him, pressing herself right to him while he lay on his side, her on her back. He kissed her cheek, and it made her smile, made him make happy sounds in his throat. It was sweet and loving and while Max viewed it again through the center of a green ring of jealousy, there was something about it that made him feel good. So he nuzzled in next to her on her other side, getting himself pressed right to her and it made her laugh. Looking down he could see her belly bouncing lightly. He kissed her cheek as well, and put a knee overlapping her thigh. She purred and rubbed up against both of them, reached down to her hip, pulled on Cole's cock, stretching it until it came free and bounced on her leg. Pulled his scrotum up too, ran her hand along it, then gripped his penis lightly, the pad of her thumb resting in the folds of his foreskin. Max reached down and grabbed the sheets, tugged to cover them, and that was the way they all fell asleep.

Breakup

THURSDAY, OCTOBER 12TH

"YOU HAVE to tell him it's over," Cole said.

Maggie said, "I can't."

"No. I know. I'll do it. You have to be here with me. He has to see you, see that you're serious."

"God. Why? ..." she whined, rhetorically, looking up at the grey sky.

"You know why. Stop leading him on."

"Okay...okay..."

She sat on the concrete edge of a twenty-foot circular garden at a cross-path in the Oren Glen. She'd been dreading this for days. Hated confrontation and hurt, and this had both in store. But Cole was right, they had to do this.

Cole wasn't sitting. He'd been next to her for a while, but stood and now had been pacing for a quarter of an hour. He was strong, but he was not looking forward to this either.

"Come, sit with me," she said softly, holding a hand out to him. The pacing was making it harder on her.

Their hands came together, and he sat heavily on the concrete by her side. He sighed, "What time is it?"

"It's twenty-after," she said, checking her phone.

"Where is he?"

"Oh shit," she whispered, spotting him at a distance, weaving through passing students on the path under the canopy of leaves gone almost white.

"Here he comes."

Now her heart thudded and her neck swelled tight against the collar of her shirt. She gripped Cole's hand, and second thoughts tore her apart. Her head rolled around on her shoulders and she looked away from him, her stomach muscles flexed, her glutes joining in; she began to rock.

Cole inhaled, sighed out, "Okay," and he let her hand go.

"Cole, wait," she said as he stood. "Don't. Maybe, let's not..."

"Maggie. Be serious. It's over."

"I know, I know," she whined. "Don't do anything stupid. Don't...don't do...just if I see you get hurt I will die, Cole, I swear. I couldn't stand to see you be hurt. Please..."

"I'm not stupid, Maggie. I know what I'm doing."

He stood up as Jay drew near enough they read the concerned expression on his face.

"He's really strong, Cole...please..."

"I told you to trust me," he said. Jay approached the two of them, eyes darting from one to the other, half-smiling, brow lowered.

A half-smile pulled awkwardly at her own cheeks in mimicry and she averted her eyes as Cole stepped in between Jay and her. He put his hand out, five fingers extended.

"Stop, stop," he said, with mild authority.

"What?" Jay said, puzzled anger creasing his brow.

"No more."

"No more what? Who are you? Maggie...?"

Her eyes darted up to see Jay looking at her past Cole's shoulder. She looked down at her loafers.

Cole said, "Look man, it's over. It has to be over."

"What the fuck are you talking about?"

"You had your fun, okay? I get it. It's seriously time to walk away."

Jay laughed incredulously, and with an easy confidence. Cole was a bit bigger than him, taller at least, but she knew Jay had no doubt he could throw Cole face first on the concrete. If he did, she would die; seeing her Cole hurt would break her heart. "I had my fun?"

"She's getting married. You know she's getting married."

"Who are you?"

"I'm her Best Man."

Jay dismissed him with a "Whatever," waved him away and peered around his shoulder. "Maggie, talk to me."

She looked up at the two of them through her brows but she didn't speak. Cole stayed between them, but Jay wasn't trying to get around him.

Cole said, "Why would you do this to her? You knew she was engaged..."

Jay came eye to eye with Cole, said, "What's your name?"

"Cole."

"Get the fuck out of my business, Cole."

Maggie hissed, "Hey."

Jay said, "What? Who the fuck is he?"

"I told you I'm the Best Man. Maggie came to her senses, okay? She knows this is wrong. She's getting married and you ought to know better than to do what you did."

"What did I do?" he said, his mouth in a firm, mean line.

"C'mon, man. You know what you did, and you know how shitty it was..."

Jay continued to stare into Cole's eyes and Cole didn't back down. After a long, uncomfortable moment, Cole said, "You knew she was engaged."

Jay shook his head, looked away. Around Cole's shoulder, to Maggie, he said, "I didn't make you do anything you didn't want to do."

Maggie said, "I know, Jay, I—"

"We know, man. I'm not saying that," Cole said, putting a hand out again, getting some distance between them. "What happened, happened. She knows it was a mistake. She wants it to be over now."

"She does? Maggie...?"

Her shoulders slumped, and she looked up at Jay. Her handsome, accomplished Jay. He'd tempted her, shown her the things that could be hers and that she'd never had. Dangled that big carrot, and while he was exciting and intoxicating in many ways, she had enough control to resist. It was her Max who had guided her into his arms and into his pants. She bit her lip, afraid to speak.

Cole urged Jay, "C'mon, man, just go."

Jay said, "She can make her own decisions."

"No, she can't. You're taking advantage of her."

"I'm what?"

"She's young and impressionable, and you're manipulating her for sex."

Jay laughed, folded his arms. "What's her fiancé doing? She's so young and impressionable but she's ready to marry? She's too young to be

married, and she knows it. I'm good for her. This guy she's marrying, this fucking Max, he's the one taking advantage of her."

"Don't say that, Jay," she said.

He looked past Cole again, his expression open, compelling. "Is it true, Maggie? What he's saying...? ..."

She nodded, tears welling up suddenly, wiped them away with her fingers while her mouth twisted up. She couldn't look at him, but she said, "I don't love you, Jay. I'm sorry. I just wanted to have sex, but I know I shouldn't. I can't anymore. I can't see you anymore."

"Maggie, don't..."

"I have to do the right thing, Jay," she cried. "For Max's sake. For your sake. I care about you too, but..."

She got control of herself, inhaled, blinked, wiped her cheeks dry with the inside wrists of her sweater. She sniffed, cleared her throat. Looking him in the eye, she said, "What we did was wrong. It's not going anywhere, okay? It was just sex. It's over now." Her lips pursed, and she held his gaze.

He didn't show her anger. He showed her nothing. His expression blank and unreadable. He nodded twice, a short, slow movement, then he turned around and walked away. Didn't say a thing, didn't even look at Cole again. They watched him walk the path until he disappeared from sight.

A sadness ached through her but she didn't cry. Didn't show it in any way. She breathed deeply, in through her nose out through her mouth, her back straight, her hands crossed in her lap. Cole said nothing either, just sat right next to her, looking straight ahead, his hip touching hers. He looked to her after a long while of sitting and watching students pass. She smiled, and he smiled back but there was trouble in his eyes and she imagined he could read the same trouble in her eyes too.

COLE HELD her hand as they left the Glen. Walking across the intersection, heading off campus and passing under the sign for FarmFresh, he said, "You know I'm not seeing anyone. Not since that weekend at your house. I want to be exclusive with you. All right?"

"Exclusive with me?"

"Yeah, I'd like that."

“You haven't been seeing other girls?”

“I told you my dick was on a break,” he laughed. “It wants to spend time focusing on you.”

“I can tell,” she laughed now too. “Me too. I want that.”

They cut through the back streets behind the village's main thoroughfare. Cold and grey today but they were both dressed for it in sweaters and jackets. They didn't wear gloves and their palms were warm against each other while the backs of their hands stung with October cold.

“I didn't...you know I didn't want to sleep with Jay. Not really, at least.”

“I know. You told me.”

“Yeah, I was just curious.”

“I know. I'm not mad. You should have told me. I wasn't using condoms with you.”

“I'm sorry. I trusted Jay.”

“Maggie. First rule is to never trust a man. You can't trust them. Max, yes. Me, yes. But you've known me for years.”

“It was stupid.”

“Max didn't make him wear a condom?”

“I think he wanted me to take it bare.”

Cole grunted and squeezed her hand. She could see him shaking his head.

“Sorry,” she said.

They had passed between two houses, on a narrow pathway that led to the park where Max had proposed to her. They were cutting through a children's play set, the village tennis courts on their left side, closed up for the season, the nets packed away in some municipal building. He stopped her then, both of them coming to a halt in the wet sand of the playground. They were alone, the weather not favorable for swings, teeter-totters, monkey bars... Facing her, he stepped into her space, pushing her back until she pressed against the painted metal rails of an eight-foot-tall geodesic climbing dome. He looked in her eyes and she didn't shy away, stared back into his trembling blues and read his distress.

His hand still held hers and he said, “Don't let Max get control of you.”

“What do you mean?”

“He's making bad decisions for you, Maggie.”

“They're my decisions too, Cole,” she said, her back arcing as he leaned her on the dome.

“They're my decisions now.”

“Okay.”

He kissed the point of her chin, making a soft sucking noise with his lips. She tilted her head up to the sky, let him kiss her neck. A tingle went through her when his thighs pressed against hers. She slipped her free hand along his back, kissed his lips. It was soft and delicate, their pressing wet flesh making suction noises, their breaths coming heavy through their noses.

She said, “You're going to take control of me?”

“I am. I'm going to give you the things you're missing. We'll do it my way.”

“What about Max? What about his control over me?”

Cole thought about it a moment, looking in her eyes, squeezing her hand, his other hand on her waist and tummy. “If you feel someone has control over you, there's no better way to get out from under them than to fuck another person.”

“That work for you?”

“Maybe.”

“Some girl got a hold of you...”

“I fucked her best friend or her sister.”

“And what if that someone, the one with all the control, is my father?”

“Fathers are the biggest cuckolds on the planet.”

“Ha ha, what? ...”

“Your dad...raised you, cared for you, turned you into this incredible woman standing in front of me. He spent hundreds of thousands turning you into this fucking beautiful genius. He made this perfect creature...”

One strong hand gripped her hip, his other tracing her hair from her face, smoothing it behind her ear.

She whispered, “Yeah? ...”

“And I slide my big dick up inside it...”

“Mm-hmm...” she hummed, her hand running up the outside of his thigh, in between his legs and running over the bulge in his denim. He was aroused, not erect, but hot and straining against the fabric.

He said, “Come inside it. Make it my own. I claim you.”

“You do that.”

“I can make you so happy, Maggie.”

“Cole...”

He smiled wide and mean, the smile making his eyes close to twinkling slits. "You know I can, Margaret."

"I...I want to make you happy. Right now." She pinched the flesh of his penis through his pants, running her finger and thumb up and down its shape and testing its growing firmness.

"Show me," he whispered, coming close to her and his breath tickling her ear. His long hair fell forward and brushed her cheek. With both her hands hidden under the lapels of his peacoat she unzipped his jeans. No underwear, as she found was usual with Cole, and she reached in, his pubic hair tickling at her skin. Found his penis then, hot and gummy, semi-erect, brought it out of his fly into the cold and stroked him. She said, "I want to suck your cock. Out in public where anyone might see us."

He kissed her lips again, smiling against her as he did, his lips pulling tight, making her smile too, like it was infectious.

"Yeah?" she whispered, the excitement hardening him in her grip.

"Yeah," he agreed.

Her back slipped down the dome, bumping from rail to rail until she was down on her heels, her rump resting on the backs of her legs, her knees shooting out on either side of his calves. Cole's thick cock sprouted from between the navy flaps of his coat. Proudly large, hard and ready, looking for some hot girl to suck it. She was that hot girl.

When she was in music camp, the year she was fifteen, there was a blonde-haired preppy girl, Tabby, who played the piano and had her clique of ice-faced preppy witches at her beck and call. Maggie had overheard her describing going down on her boyfriend (a drop dead gorgeous college boy, said preppy girl only seventeen at the time), and it was one of those moments that forever stuck with her. The girl had said it was in the park and Maggie had always pictured it much like this one. An empty playground, the one she'd played on at her private grade school in Rhode Island.

She posed for Cole the way she'd always imagined that pretty white girl had, ran her tongue on his tip, peeling back his foreskin and swathing that sensitive underpart of him that would make his eyes roll back. She circled thumb and forefinger on his shaft where it emerged from his fly amidst sprouts of his pubic hair. Even gripping it tightly so his veins would stand out, her grip wouldn't meet.

Max had told her she was good at oral sex, so had Cole. So had Jay. She gave Cole her finest treatment. Wanting him to appreciate her talent and

hard work, wanting him under control, even if it were just for a few minutes. She had him shaking and jumping. She teased him with her tongue, sucked his glans, swirled around all the shapes. Tugged on his foreskin, then plunged deep. It was a crazy thought, but she wanted someone to interrupt them. She wanted to be spotted. She wanted recognition from strangers—or even better, students she recognized—as a sexual being. Not that really nice Asian girl who always had her homework done and played a cello quite well. She wanted her peers to know she had power.

When Cole began to leak a delightful surge of buttery excitement into her mouth, she smiled around his spit-slick cock, plunged him deep, ran her hands down his thighs then up the backs of his legs, coming up to grab handfuls of his perfect ass and squeeze. Then when he realized he was close and what she wanted his hips thrust and she encouraged him, her hands helping his movements. She wanted her face fucked. Wanted to gag on his fat tool. And the thought of the reality—and then pairing those dirty thoughts and dirty words with it—she soaked through her panties, the air cold against her damp cotton under her skirt. She gave up a hand, let it fall from Cole's ass and dip between her legs, press herself, work over the panties.

Cole gripped her hair, fucked her deep in her mouth and it was incredible. Her eyes squeezed shut tight, but they were rolling back in her sockets with wild pleasure. Her hand buzzed between her legs, finding her hood, peeling it so she pressed the pads of her fingers on the swollen cotton shroud of her clit.

Cole growled and choked when he came and his semen squirted from him with exciting force, splashing the back of her throat and urging the eggs she had for breakfast to come up for a visit, but she choked it back, gagged and swallowed, her face swelling up and turning red, and semen and spit flowing from either side of her stretched out mouth and probably staining her skirt. But she bobbed her head to meet her lover's thrusts, getting him deep, that large glans bumping her esophagus, making her spew more bile. She coughed and spluttered around him as the semen continued to flow in urgent dashes. She drank him, all she could, losing only a little out the sides, but drinking his fluid and enjoying it. And as he flexed his cock, and it swelled up against her palette, and she felt the last of his satisfied oozing

into her mouth, accompanied by a long ecstatic groan above her, she finally came too.

She cried out, but his cock let no sound escape and instead a bubble swelled from her nostril, burst, tickled her and made her shiver. She fell against his legs, his slippery cock squirting wetly past her lips and she gasped for breath, hugged his knees with one arm, her hand clamped firmly against her pussy between her thighs as she rode out a long-legged, shivering orgasm.

When she came out of it, gasping and heaving, she looked around, disappointed to find they were still alone. No one had discovered how bad they were—how bad and dirty she was.

MAX CHECKED his watch when he saw them coming. They were a little late, but he was glad to see them. He sat at a tall table in the front window, just under the apex of ALTIERI'S written in gold. Maggie and Cole walked the sidewalk together, and he noted with a jab in his belly that they held hands. Maggie's face was happy, smiling, listening as Cole told her something. Then she laughed, hunching at the waist it was so funny.

Sure, he seized with jealousy at the sight of them like this but he deserved punishment. The game had got away from him. He'd stepped up to the plate and swung too big. Wrapped his arms right around himself and got hit in the face with his own bat. Didn't knock himself out, thankfully, but he made a fool of himself, and the coach wasn't likely to send him up to the plate again any time soon.

He was content to sit in the back seat for the last few days. They'd all been very busy, and while he deserved coldness from Maggie she didn't deliver. There was a rift, but she hadn't shown him less love. For that he was very grateful.

She and Cole hadn't been together (that he heard), and due to scheduling, neither had they. They texted, talked on the phone, but hadn't spent time one-on-one. She needed her space, and frankly, he needed some too. He'd done some bad things recently, and they'd been for him, not for her. It wasn't lost on him that today would be the day she was to meet Jay

but instead the three of them were getting together, spending the afternoon at Altieri's and this evening? ...Who knew? He had hopes.

As they entered the vestibule together, he polished the beer he'd started, then topped his glass and poured one for each of them. He'd already ordered and the food would be here soon.

Maggie cocked her head with affection when she saw him, cooed, "Maxy," and came to him. She put her arms around his neck and she hugged him.

A tremor passed through him feeling that contact with her. His arms circled her back, and he hugged her tight. She pulled back, looked in his eyes and he stared up into her ambers, a smile being drawn from him.

There was that rift. They were in love, but a divide had interrupted them, the earth rending between their feet. He reached across the chasm to her...

...Kissed her, his lips coming to hers and planting firmly. He breathed her in. Smelled something. Something not right. He knew what it was, but he pushed the thought away.

"Hey man," Cole said, slapping his back. Now he hugged him too, Cole bending and putting his arms around him and holding him for a few heartbeats.

"Hey buddy," Max whispered to him.

Cole took Maggie's coat and held the stool out for her. She stepped up onto it, flicked her ponytail back and sat. Cole sat next to her, took his beer glass and held it up, said, "Cheers."

Max laughed with relief, Maggie smiled; they all lifted their mugs and touched rims and swigged their beer.

"Pizza's on its way, guys," Max said.

Maggie said, "Good, I'm starving."

"How you been, Maxy?" Cole asked.

"Good. Busy," he said. Cole clasped his hand over Maggie's while they talked and Maggie didn't shy away. Max watched her delicate, manicured thumb run back and forth over Cole's first knuckle. His stomach twisted with angst but his cock swelled with excitement. They would all get together tonight. He was sure of it. Excitement chased the fear away.

Maggie had a thing for Cole. That was all right. He noted how she'd woken him at The Poirot, stroked his leg and aroused him, how it was obviously a ploy to also make love with Cole. He wasn't blind nor was he

stupid. She primed Max, and that gave her license to wake Cole. He had respect and privilege as the fiancé and she honored it. They'd all had incredible sex that night. They would again. And each minute he spent with her he would work on patching their divide.

Eyes on their joined hands he extended his own, sliding it between his glass and the pitcher, palm up across the red-and-white vinyl gingham. Maggie watched it coming, smiled, took his thumb and gripped it, and he closed his hand around hers. There was a tremble in her.

She said, "Max, I want to spend some time with Cole."

His insides flinched, but he held it together. He said, "Okay."

"Is that okay?" she asked.

"Without me?"

"Well...I mean, yeah. Like, I want to be open."

"An open relationship? With me and Cole?"

"Yeah."

"Until the wedding?"

"Mm-hmm."

"There's going to be a wedding?" he said with purposeful petulance. It was easier to parody it out in the open than to try to hide it.

She looked pained, her eyes darted to Cole. "Yes, Max. There will be."

He sighed, his eyes on hers, noticed they were unwavering. His mouth worked from side to side while he considered her. He said, "Okay."

"And...I'm...I'm going to take the LSAT. I want to go to law school."

"Law school?" he blurted.

She nodded.

He let her hand go, looked to the ceiling. When he was done shaking his head, he looked across at her. Nodding toward Cole, he said, "Is this his idea?"

Cole said, "Hey, Max, no...it's not."

"No, it's not. It's my idea, Max. I ran it past my parents last weekend. I've been concerned for a while."

"That's a big idea, Maggie. You ran it past your parents, past Cole, but not me?"

"I'm running it past you now."

"Practically after the fact."

"Do you think I should go to law school?"

He threw his hands up, said, "Yeah. If you want."

“I want. It’s a good idea.”

“Where? Fucking Harvard?”

“Yeah—”

“Great. That’s great.”

Maggie let Cole’s hand go now, and she clasped hers together, drew them up so the thumbs touched her chin. Her shoulders hunched with a measure of irritation. She said, “What...? You think I want to work at a gallery? Maybe throw some paint around and try to get representation? Come home to you, and what’s our life going to be? You’re practically working for my father...and I’m still...”

“What?”

“I still need my parents,” she said, lowering her eyes.

“Jesus, Maggie. I won’t take the job at fucking Oxbow. I don’t give a shit. Is that what you want?”

“Max, I want you to know what you’re doing.”

He thumped a fist on the table, turned to Cole, “Are you fucking poisoning her? What the fuck is happening here?”

“Hey,” she hissed, her brow lowered meanly. “Hey. No one poisons me, Max. This is me. I’m saying this.”

They stared at each other, eyes shooting darts across the table. He breathed heavy, chest rising and falling, an anger ripping through him but he had no idea who it was directed at. Cole. Maggie. Himself.

He reeled, sat away from the table, put his back against the stool’s rest. Now he folded his arms, regarded his sweet Maggie across the table. The rift was growing.

There was a stern look on her face. One that was serious and unforgiving and he hadn’t seen that from her before. She was dressed nicely, less playfully; a crisp shirt, dark sweater, a plaid skirt with leggings. Her fun kiltie loafers were replaced with black leather.

Shit. Her hair. The blue and platinum locks were gone.

He laughed, showed them a pleasant face, put both hands up, gave them his palms in surrender. When he leaned forward and put them together, they were sweaty. “Maggie, I support you one-hundred percent.”

He dried one hand on the back of the other, reached over and took her hand without asking. he said, “I’ve got your back. LSAT, Harvard... I want you to have all the things you want. I’ll help you make them happen.”

That brought a smile to her face. He was buying himself some time.

Cole smiled too, an easiness washing through him, loosening the tension from his posture. He took up Maggie's other hand.

Max reached out and lay a palm up for Cole and he took it. Now they were ringing the table, three people with joined hands. Three good friends with some tears and cracks, some decay in the roots, a little crumbling in the foundation. Tonight they would all get naked. Not sure where. Someone's dorm room. He would watch the pleasure Cole gave Maggie, he would watch her face when she was fucked into a squirting orgasm. He would join in. He would help. He would be the things she needed right now. Tonight he and his friends would have dirty fun.

But tomorrow morning he would begin throwing switches.

Afterword

Sign up for my newsletter to get the latest info, sneak peeks at upcoming stories, and even a free story or two down the road!

<http://eepurl.com/bYsVwH>

[Visit my blog!](#)

Other Books by KT Morrison

MAGGIE Series

[Tempting Maggie](#)

[Sharing Maggie](#)

[Secret Maggie](#)

Exploring Maggie

Discovering Maggie

Max is a fourth year Government and Policy student engaged to wed the love of his life.

Maggie is a fourth year Art student and she can't wait for the summer to come so she can finally tie the knot with the guy she fell in love with when they were Freshmen.

They've been together four years at their prestigious private college nestled in the Green Mountains of Vermont. This is the year they'll graduate and set out into the world together as a couple.

But Maggie is surprised to find her desires set on fire by a gorgeous new figure model. She thinks she'd never cheat but she can't stop thinking about him.

When Max learns her secret he's crushed. It tears down everything he knows about her. But in the rubble he finds something shining: excitement.

Now, if he could just convince her it's okay...

Learning Lessons

A Losing His Wife Novel

This long series is now one novel! A 160,000 word cuckold tragedy...

Pete and Jess Mapplethorpe have been married for seven years now. They've got two wonderful little boys and an Irish Setter. Everyone that knows them would say they are the nicest couple you'd want to meet.

Well, they might say that Pete can be a bit of a jerk sometimes—but Jess? Regional Grade Three teacher of the year, three years running. Pretty, polite, sensitive, kind and thoughtful...

It must have been black magic that brought them together...

Behind closed doors everyone would be shocked at what goes on. They'd never believe the dirty things that sweet Jess might do or say. Pete doesn't think he has what it takes to please his beautiful wife and they fantasize about larger men taking her and making her happy.

She's just starting to discover herself at thirty-five... She wants to make up for lost time.

They've found a handsome, well-built young man to play along. It's better than they even imagined. Now that they've started will she be able to stop? What if she doesn't want to?

Her husband loves enduring distressing levels of humiliation and she's finding a crazy pleasure now in delivering it...

Losing His Wife 2 Series

[Losing His Wife 2: Box 1](#)

[Losing His Wife 2: Box 2](#)

[Losing His Wife 2: Box 3](#)

Geoff J. Kane is a successful children's book illustrator. Ten years ago he married the girl of his dreams. She'd been his best friend and he'd helped her through tough relationships and gave her his shoulder to cry on many nights. Then after two years, she kissed him. Now they're married and they've got a beautiful seven-year-old daughter.

Nia Kane was a wild one. She liked to have fun and she liked to cause trouble. Everything she did, in the end, blew up in her face, hurt her. One night she realized the best man in her life was sitting with her, telling her it was all going to be okay. She kissed him and it was wonderful and he's always good to her.

Their daughter is growing up, she's away at school now and it seems like it might be a good idea for Nia to return to the workforce. The city isn't getting any cheaper. She gets a job offer from an old friend. The brother of her very hot ex-boyfriend. She cried on her husband's shoulder a lot over this guy, back when Geoff was just her buddy.

Having her ex back in her life stirs up old feelings in both of them. They both like it. There was something exciting about that time when they were twenty. It's safe now. He's got her. They can fantasize, right?

Obsessed Series

[Obsessed: Book One](#)

[Obsessed: Book Two](#)

Four couples lives intertwine as they explore their erotic boundaries. From simple wife-watching to cuckolding and domination and humiliation, these couples have one thing in common: they all share the same incredible bull. And he is far more than they even expected.

Mike and Gretch: Not married, but dating for a good long while. Two comedy writers just at the edge of love, that strange and delicate space where the act of sharing can be so dangerous. But they're two cool cats and they're sure they've got it all locked down. They call her ex-boyfriend from college, Atticus Hawke, a guy who has in the years since their breakup, and before Mike, been a reliable booty call for her.

Sean and Courtney: Sean's a Type A stick of dynamite. A rocketing studio exec, competitive and driven, he shares an incredible bond with his gym-toned wife. Courtney is all in for the new game she and her handsome husband have devised. Their ten-year-old daughter is out of the house and away at

boarding school. They've planned a one-year commitment to one another about honesty, openness, and exploration. They're going for broke. Their new thing? Sean likes to watch and Court likes to be watched. They've found a guy online. He seems too good to be true. A guy called Finch, endowed, muscular, handsome like a fashion model. Courtney's been working out and she's going to put this stud through his paces.

Steve and Becky: Becky's a headstrong X-Ray technician who landed herself a multi-millionaire tech investor husband thirty years her senior. Steve loves to be dominated and he found the girl of his dreams in Becky. She's got an iron will and she loves her husband. Loves him enough to lock him in chastity and keep him abstinent for months on end. It's okay, don't worry about Becky, she gets a regular visit from a drop-dead gorgeous man named Finch. He keeps her satisfied. Sometimes, if he's been good, she'll even let her husband watch.

JJ and Amy: Two young country bumpkins just arrived in Los Angeles. JJ wants to live a lifestyle he's only dreamed of and this city is part of it. He's married to the sweetest little nineteen-year-old outta Jackson Pond, South Carolina and he's sure she's on a fast ticket to stardom. She just needs her first big break. While they're waiting he's got a fantasy he wants to see lived out. He would do anything to see his little Amy with a man who's got a big one, one'll make her scream like those girls he watches on the internet. He found a guy online, one Amy didn't make her vomit-face at. He's got everything JJ's been looking for and, thank the stars, he's agreed to do it.

Atticus Hawke: Finch is his online name. His nighttime name. The one he uses on a site that puts him in touch with couples looking for a bull just like him. By day he is Atticus Hawke. You might have heard of him. You know the song from the eighties, 'Going With That Girl'? No? You'd know it if you heard it. That was Atticus' dad, Ricky Hawke. Yes, that Ricky Hawke. Now you know. Made a bunch of singer-songwriter hits in a time when all the kids wanted pop coming out of synthesizers and their stars to be pretty boys and have colourful hair. Ricky had real talent. So does Atticus. One of L.A.'s hottest emerging Modern artists, his work commands a fortune. But it pales against his enormous trust fund. These days his real work is done at night. His masterpieces. That's where his passion is. Watching and participating in intense psychological dramas in dark hotel rooms across the city. He gives women what they want. They're a canvas, a medium. His audience: their husband.

The Cayman Proxy Series:

The Cayman Proxy (Box One)

Mitchell Sutton's family is one of the wealthiest in London. But Mitch is an outsider, the handsome young son who took his own path. He's in love with a girl from the wrong side of the tracks.

Kate's a troubled Council house girl thrown into a lifestyle she never imagined. But she's more than his dressed up little princess.

He's got just about everything she needs. But she's got a mind full of dark thoughts she can't escape. And there's something Mitch can't give her.

She needs something his money can't buy.

He would do anything for her.

They hit the hot beaches of Grand Cayman, a reunion with an old friend and a handsome stranger. Passion boils in her blood. Can she make this work or will her desires destroy the man she loves?

Going A Little Too Far

You couldn't picture a sweeter couple than Troy and Emma.

Troy's a former Division One college wrestler. A walking water park at two-sixty-five, with shoulders no woman could get her arms around and a set of abs you could scrub laundry on.

Emma's a sweet little Georgia Peach. Pretty as can be in her proper dresses; she's a good girl from a good family that raised her right.

You couldn't tell by looking at them that they were two straight-up freaks that loved to push each other's kinky buttons.

Emma, with all her book club shyness, loves to be man-handled, loves to be lifted off her feet and dominated. Troy is a monster with a six-hundred-fifty pound deadlift and she's like a feather in his arms.

Troy likes to be humiliated. He knows he doesn't have much 'down there' and he likes his virginal wife to tell him he's no good and she'd have to get what she wanted elsewhere.

Couple of closet freaks.

A summer housewarming party on a scorching hot West Texas day puts a gift in their lap. A big, larger-than-life playtoy for Emma to tease her husband with. He wants her to. She wants to do it. But once it starts, where do you stop? What's going too far?

Taken While He Watches: On Their Honeymoon

Ken and Ashley just got married and while money is super-tight they've got themselves a weekend getaway in the Honeymoon Suite looking out over the ocean on the sunny Carolina coast.

The room was a steal. Turns out it's Bike Week and no one books the Honeymoon Suite during Bike Week. Especially not two dopey white kids from the suburbs.

A mix-up leaves them in trouble and they don't know how they can get out of it, don't even know how they'll get home. They get some help from their hotel neighbours. A half dozen handsome, muscular, and very wealthy black men.

Ken's wary but Ash is all in.

When they find out she's saved herself for her special night she becomes the star of the show and they'll offer anything to help her...

Ken doesn't like it but she's going to do what they ask. She says it's for their future...

Taken While He Watches: At The Combine

Coralee has put her own career on hold to help her husband keep his Sports Podcast afloat. He's spent eighty grand on his tiny entertainment empire.

Bobby just needs a big break. His business is a half second away from going belly-up. When their camera captures an XXL wardrobe malfunction by the combine's star prospect they see an opportunity.

Coralee will do anything to get an interview with him. She'll use the video as leverage. She'll get to this bad boy super-athlete, even if she has to break into the locker room...

She's doing it to save the family business, right?

Taken By His Best Friends: At The Hockey Rink

Marguerite was a sexy little French student Randall fell in love with at college. She loved hockey. He played hockey.

They fell in love and they married. They live a regular 9 to 5 now, but Randall and his best friends still play once a week. They are four big guys and they play rough and Marguerite is always there to cheer them from the stands.

When they all end up alone in the locker room after a bench-clearing brawl passions are already high. And when some innocent flirting starts it quickly tumbles out of control.

Marguerite does nothing to stop it. Randall is frozen...

He's going to watch his best friends do all the dirty things they've ever dreamed of doing to his wife...

Measured Next To Her Ex: A Medical Size Comparison Cuckold Fantasy

When Ben Watson went to the new Sexual Performance Clinic across from his office he was just looking to get some help.

But when he showed up on Opening Day the place was so overwhelmed they started doubling up in exam rooms to make sure all the patients were assessed.

Of all the gin joints in all the—

Guess who his exam partner is? Yeah, his honey-pie's ex-boyfriend. He is going to be sitting next to him, knees practically touching, while these nurses assess their size and performance using only their latex hands.

He could leave, get the hell out of there. That would be sensible. But he's kind of curious. A dark part of him wants to know something. Wants to know what his precious girl's ex-lover has between his legs.

He's going to wish he left.

Then, when his obscenely endowed exam mate starts to relate to the nurses the casual but very dirty hook-ups he's been having with an ex, Ben's hands really start sweating.

This is going to be the worst day of Ben's life.

Size Curious Brat

Matt Walsh is on his way home from Harvard. It's Thanksgiving recess and he hasn't been with his sweet Chloe Rose in months. He can't wait to get off the bus and wrap his arms around his baby girl.

Chloe's a perverted little high-schooler with a habit for trouble. She loves her boyfriend Matt and she's been aching for him.

But there's a problem.

Matt's step brother came home early. He's a bully. A domineering man's man who made Matt's life miserable growing up. Now he's a sexy deep-sea welder just getting home from Louisiana after two months at sea and he hasn't even seen a woman in ages.

After a brief, naked encounter in the hallway little Chloe can't get something out of her mind. Matt's stepbrother Moric is built much better than other men and she can't stop thinking about it.

It makes Matt mad but Chloe is just naturally curious. She doesn't think it's a big deal. She's just never seen anything like that before.

Now Moric's got his eyes on his little brother's prize possession. She's not exactly unwilling. Moric is a big powerful stud and Matt is powerless to stop him. Once he starts neither of them could stop him. He could take whatever he wants. It might be better—if Moric would let him—to just join him...